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Laundry treating apparatus

Abstract

A laundry treating apparatus includes a first treating apparatus having a first front panel, and a first drum disposed therein for accommodating laundry therein; a second treating apparatus disposed below the first treating apparatus to support the first treating apparatus, wherein the second treating apparatus has a second front panel, and a second drum disposed therein for accommodating laundry therein; and a control panel disposed between the first front panel and the second front panel. The control panel communicates a signal with the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/192,472, filed on Mar. 4, 2021, which claims the benefit of Korean Patent Application No. 10-2020-0027209, filed on Mar. 4, 2020, which are hereby incorporated by reference as if fully set forth herein.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to a laundry treating apparatus, and relates to a laundry treating apparatus including a first treating apparatus as an upper treating apparatus and a second treating apparatus as a lower treating apparatus.

BACKGROUND

(2) A laundry treating apparatus is an apparatus that puts laundry such as clothes, bedding, and the like into a drum to perform treatment necessary for the laundry, such as to remove contamination from the laundry or to dry the laundry.

(3) When the laundry treating apparatus is designed to remove the contamination from the laundry, the laundry treating apparatus may perform processes such as washing, rinsing, dehydration, drying, and the like. The laundry treating apparatuses may be classified into a top loading type laundry treating apparatus and a front loading type laundry treating apparatus based on a scheme of putting the laundry into the drum.

(4) The laundry treating apparatus may include a cabinet forming an appearance of the laundry treating apparatus, a tub accommodated in the cabinet, a drum that is rotatably mounted inside the tub and into which the laundry is put, and a detergent feeder that feeds detergent into the drum.

(5) When the drum is rotated by a motor while wash water is supplied to the laundry accommodated in the drum, dirt on the laundry may be removed by friction with the drum and the wash water.

(6) The detergent feeder has a detergent feeding function to improve a washing effect. Herein, the detergent means a substance, such as fabric detergent, fabric softener, fabric bleach, and the like, that enhances the washing effect. Detergent in a powder form and detergent in a liquid form may be used as the detergent.

(7) In one example, when the laundry treating apparatus is designed to dry the laundry, the laundry treating apparatus may remove moisture from the laundry by supplying dry air to the laundry.

(8) The laundry treating apparatus may include a cabinet, a drum rotatably disposed inside the cabinet, heating means for heating or drying the air supplied to the laundry, and the like.

(9) As the dry air is supplied to the laundry accommodated in the drum, the moisture present in the laundry may be evaporated and removed by the dry air, and water may be removed from the laundry.

(10) In one example, a laundry treating apparatus includes a plurality of treating apparatuses together. The laundry treating apparatus has a first treating apparatus as an upper treating apparatus and a second treating apparatus as a lower treating apparatus.

(11) Each of the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus may have each laundry inlet communicating with each drum inside each cabinet and may have a control panel. When detergent is used, a detergent storage unit inlet may be formed in the cabinet.

(12) As described above, various components as needed may be received in the cabinet defining an appearance of the laundry treating apparatus. However, installing a plurality of components in a limited area may be complicated in terms of design. Depending on locations of the components, installing the plurality of components in a limited area may cause inconvenience to the user.

Further, installing the plurality of components in the limited area may be disadvantageous in determination of a coupling structure between the plurality of components.

(13) Accordingly, a stable structure of the laundry treating apparatus should be implemented by efficiently arranging the plurality of components that may be provided in the laundry treating apparatus. Further, coupling stability between the components should be secured while improving utility and ease of use of each of the components.

SUMMARY

(14) Embodiments of the present disclosure are intended to provide a laundry treating apparatus in which arrangement between components provided in a first treating apparatus and a second treating apparatus may be effectively achieved.

(15) In addition, embodiments of the present disclosure are intended to provide a laundry treating apparatus in which convenience of use of the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus may be effectively improved.

(16) In addition, embodiments of the present disclosure are intended to provide a laundry treating apparatus in which couplings between components of the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus may be made efficiently.

(17) A laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may include a plurality of treating apparatuses. The first treating apparatus may dry laundry, and the second treating apparatus may wash the laundry.

(18) Alternatively, both the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus may dry or wash laundry. Alternatively, the first treating apparatus may wash laundry, and the second treating apparatus may dry laundry.

(19) The first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus may have a structure stacked together in a vertical direction. That is, the first treating apparatus may be disposed on the second treating apparatus.

(20) Each of the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus has a laundry inlet into which the laundry is inserted defined at a front face thereof, and each drum for accommodating therein the laundry inserted into each cabinet through each laundry inlet may be in a front loader form whose rotation axis direction is parallel to a front and rear direction.

(21) A control panel that is signally connected to the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus may be disposed between the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus. The control panel may form a portion of a front face of the laundry treating apparatus. For example, the control panel may be disposed between a first front panel of the first treating apparatus and a second front panel of the second treating apparatus, so that a front face of the control panel may be exposed forward.

(22) An embodiment of the present disclosure may control the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus through one control panel. The control panel may include a display for displaying operating states of the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus, and a manipulation unit for a user to control the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus.

(23) In one example, the control panel may be fixed by being coupled to a lower frame disposed on a lower portion of the first treating apparatus. The lower frame may stably fix the control panel as an upper end extension supports a bottom of the first front panel and side end extensions are respectively coupled to side faces of the control panel.

(24) Such a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure includes a first treating apparatus having a first front panel disposed on a front face thereof and a first drum disposed therein for accommodating laundry therein, and a second treating apparatus disposed below the first treating apparatus to support the first treating apparatus, wherein the second treating apparatus has a second front panel disposed on a front face thereof and a second drum disposed therein for accommodating the laundry therein.

(25) In the laundry treating apparatus according to one implementation of the present disclosure, a

control panel may be disposed between the first front panel and the second front panel. The control panel may be embodied as a single body and may be connected to the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus.

(26) A single control panel may be connected, at a top thereof, to the first front panel and, at a bottom thereof, to the second front panel. That is, the first front panel and the second front panel may be connected to each other via the single control panel.

(27) Accordingly, the control panel may be placed in a location such that the user may easily check and operate the apparatus and may be embodied as a single body, thereby improving user convenience thereof.

(28) Each of the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus may have a laundry inlet and a cabinet door. Each laundry inlet and each cabinet door may be provided in and on each of the first front panel and the second front panel. Since the laundry inlet is defined in a front face of each of the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus, the user may conveniently insert or withdraw the laundry through the laundry inlet.

(29) The second treating apparatus may be a laundry washing apparatus, and the detergent opening of the second treating apparatus may be defined in a front face of an upper portion of the second treating apparatus. Accordingly, the detergent opening may be placed in a position in the second treating apparatus such that the user may easily retract or extend the detergent storage unit through the detergent opening by hand.

(30) Particular implementations of the present disclosure provide a laundry treating system that includes first and second treating apparatuses and a control panel. The first treating apparatus has a first front panel and a first drum disposed in the first treating apparatus that is configured to accommodate a first laundry therein. The second treating apparatus is disposed below the first treating apparatus and supports the first treating apparatus. The second treating apparatus has a second front panel and a second drum disposed in the second treating apparatus that is configured to accommodate a second laundry therein. The control panel is disposed between the first front panel and the second front panel and configured to communicate with the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus. The control panel is disposed at a front face of a lower portion of the first treating apparatus and is positioned below the first front panel and above the second front panel.

(31) In some implementations, the system can optionally include one or more of the following features. The control panel may be coupled to the first front panel and the second front panel and positioned to be flush with the first front panel and the second front panel. An upper end of the second front panel may be located at the front face of the lower portion of the first treating apparatus. The second front panel may have a vertical length that is greater than a vertical length of the first front panel. The first treating apparatus may have first side panels. The second treating apparatus may have second side panels. The second front panel may have a vertical length that is greater than a vertical length of each of the second side panels to thereby locate the upper end of the second front panel at the front face of the lower portion of the first treating apparatus. The first front panel may have a lower end positioned above a lower end of each of the first side panels to thereby position the control panel at a front face of the first treating apparatus. The control panel may include a front face that is disposed between the first front panel and the second front panel. The front face of the control panel may be flush with a front face of each of the first front panel and the second front panel. The front face of the control panel may have a width corresponding to a width of each of the first front panel and the second front panel. The front face of the control panel may include a first display configured to display an operating state of the first treating apparatus, and a second display configured to display an operating state of the second treating apparatus. The control panel may include a top face extending rearward from an upper end of the front face of the control panel, and a bottom face extending rearward from a lower end of the front face of the control panel. The first front panel may include a lower end bent portion extending rearward from a

lower end of the first front panel and coupled to the top face of the control panel. The second front panel may include an upper end bent portion extending rearward from an upper end of the second front panel and coupled to the bottom face of the control panel. The control panel may include side faces extending rearward from opposite lateral ends of the front face of the control panel. The first treating apparatus may have first side panels. Each of the side faces of the control panel may be vertically flush with each of the first side panels. The first front panel may include first side end bent portions extending rearward from opposite lateral ends of the first front panel. The second front panel may include second side end bent portions extending rearward from opposite lateral ends of the second front panel. Each of the side faces of the control panel may be disposed between and is vertically flush with each of the first side end bent portions and each of the second side end bent portions. The first front panel may define a first laundry inlet configured to be opened and closed by a first cabinet door. The first laundry inlet may fluidly communicate with the first drum. The second front panel may define a second laundry inlet configured to be opened and closed by a second cabinet door. The second laundry inlet may fluidly communicate with the second drum. The control panel may be disposed between the first laundry inlet and the second laundry inlet. A distance between the control panel and the first laundry inlet may be equal to a distance between the control panel and the second laundry inlet. The second treating apparatus may have a tub disposed therein. The second drum may be configured to rotate inside the tub. The second front panel may define a detergent opening configured to receive a detergent storage unit. The detergent opening of the second front panel may be located between the second laundry inlet and the control panel. The second laundry inlet may be positioned at a center of the second front panel. The detergent opening of the second front panel may be positioned to be horizontally off the center of the second front panel and located at an upper portion of the second front panel. The detergent opening of the second front panel may be located below upper ends of the second side panels. The control panel may be located above the detergent opening and the upper ends of the second side panels. The second front panel may define a filter opening configured to receive a filter configured to collect foreign substances from washing-water. The filter opening may be positioned to be horizontally off the center of the second front panel and located at a lower portion of the second front panel. A front face of the detergent storage unit may be flush with a front face of the second front panel.

(32) Particular implementations of the present disclosure provide a laundry treating system that includes first and second treating apparatuses and a control panel. The first treating apparatus has a first front panel and a first drum configured to accommodate a first laundry therein. The second treating apparatus is disposed below the first treating apparatus and supports the first treating apparatus. The second treating apparatus has a second front panel and a second drum configured to accommodate a second laundry therein. The control panel is disposed between the first front panel and the second front panel and configured to communicate with the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus. A top of the control panel is coupled to the first front panel, and a bottom of the control panel is coupled to the second front panel. A height of the first front panel is different from a height of the second front panel.

(33) One aspect of the present disclosure provides a laundry treating apparatus comprising: a first treating apparatus having a first front panel, and a first drum disposed therein for accommodating laundry therein; a second treating apparatus disposed below the first treating apparatus to support the first treating apparatus, wherein the second treating apparatus has a second front panel, and a second drum disposed therein for accommodating laundry therein; and a control panel disposed between the first front panel and the second front panel, wherein the control panel communicates a signal with the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus.

(34) In one embodiment, the control panel is disposed on a front face of a lower portion of the first treating apparatus, and faces upwards the first front panel upward and faces downwards the second front panel.

- (35) In one embodiment, the control panel is coupled to and coplanar with the first front panel and the second front panel.
- (36) In one embodiment, the second front panel is constructed so that an upper end thereof is located on a front face of a lower portion of the first treating apparatus.
- (37) In one embodiment, the second front panel has a vertical length larger than a vertical length of the first front panel.
- (38) In one embodiment, the first treating apparatus has first side panels defining both opposing side faces thereof, respectively, wherein the second treating apparatus has second side panels defining both opposing side faces thereof, respectively, wherein the second front panel has a vertical length larger than a vertical length of each of the second side panels so that an upper end of the second front panel is located on a front face of a lower portion of the first treating apparatus.
- (39) In one embodiment, the first front panel has a lower end positioned above a lower end of the first side panel, so that the control panel disposed between the first front panel and the second front panel is positioned on a front face of the first treating apparatus.
- (40) In one embodiment, the control panel includes a front face disposed between the first front panel and the second front panel and exposed frontwards, wherein the front face is vertically coplanar with a front face of each of the first front panel and the second front panel.
- (41) In one embodiment, the front face extends such that the front face has a width in a horizontal direction equal to a width of each of the first front panel and the second front panel.
- (42) In one embodiment, the front face includes: a first display for displaying an operating state of the first treating apparatus; and a second display for displaying an operating state of the second treating apparatus.
- (43) In one embodiment, the control panel includes: a top face extending rearward from an upper end of the front face; and a bottom face extending rearward from a lower end of the front face, wherein the first front panel includes a lower end bent portion extending rearward from a lower end of the first front panel and coupled to the top face, wherein the second front panel includes an upper end bent portion extending rearward from an upper end of the second front panel and coupled to the bottom face.
- (44) In one embodiment, the control panel further includes side faces extending rearward from both ends in a lateral direction of the front face, respectively, wherein the first treating apparatus has first side panels defining both opposing side faces thereof, respectively, wherein each of the side faces is vertically coplanar with each of the first side panels.
- (45) In one embodiment, the first front panel includes first side end bent portions extending rearward from both ends in a lateral direction of the first front panel, respectively, wherein the second front panel includes second side end bent portions extending rearward from both ends in a lateral direction of the second front panel, respectively, wherein each of the side faces of the control panel is disposed between and is vertically coplanar with each of the first side end bent portions and each of the second side end bent portions.
- (46) In one embodiment, the first front panel has a first laundry inlet defined therein, wherein the first laundry inlet is opened and closed by a first cabinet door, and communicates with the first drum, wherein the second front panel a second laundry inlet defined therein, wherein the second laundry inlet is opened and closed by a second cabinet door, and communicates with the second drum.
- (47) In one embodiment, the control panel is disposed between the first laundry inlet and the second laundry inlet.
- (48) In one embodiment, a spacing between the control panel and the first laundry inlet is equal to a spacing between the control panel and the second laundry inlet.
- (49) In one embodiment, the second treating apparatus has a tub disposed therein, wherein the second drum is rotatably disposed inside the tub, wherein the second front panel has a detergent opening defined therein into which a detergent storage unit is inserted, wherein the detergent

opening is located between the second laundry inlet and the control panel.

(50) In one embodiment, the second laundry inlet is positioned in a center of the second front panel, wherein the detergent opening is defined in one side in a lateral direction of the second front panel and in an upper portion of the second front panel, and is located below an upper end of the second side panel, wherein the control panel is located above the detergent opening and an upper end of the second side panel.

(51) In one embodiment, the second front panel includes a filter opening defined therein into which a filter for collecting foreign substances from washing-water is inserted, wherein the filter opening is defined in one side in a lateral direction of the second front panel and in a lower portion of the second front panel.

(52) In one embodiment, a front face of the detergent storage unit is exposed frontwards and is coplanar with a front face of the second front panel.

(53) Another aspect of the present disclosure provides a laundry treating apparatus comprising: a first treating apparatus having a first front panel, and a first drum disposed therein for accommodating laundry therein; a second treating apparatus disposed below the first treating apparatus to support the first treating apparatus, wherein the second treating apparatus has a second front panel, and a second drum disposed therein for accommodating laundry therein; and a control panel disposed between the first front panel and the second front panel, wherein the control panel communicates a signal with the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus, wherein a top of the control panel is coupled to the first front panel, and a bottom of the control panel is coupled to the second front panel, wherein vertical dimensions of the first front panel and the second front panel are different from each other.

(54) The second front panel has a length along a vertical direction larger than that of the first front panel, such that an upper end of the second front panel is disposed on a front face of a lower portion of the first treating apparatus, and a lower end of the first front panel is spaced upwardly from the upper end of the second front panel. The control panel may be inserted into a space between the lower end of the first front panel and the upper end of the second front panel and may be positioned on a front face of a lower portion of the first treating apparatus.

(55) The embodiments of the present disclosure may realize the laundry treating apparatus in which arrangement between components provided in the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus may be effectively achieved.

(56) In addition, the embodiments of the present disclosure may realize the laundry treating apparatus in which convenience of use of the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus may be effectively improved.

(57) In addition, the embodiments of the present disclosure may realize the laundry treating apparatus in which couplings between components of the first treating apparatus and the second treating apparatus may be made efficiently.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The accompanying drawings, which are included to provide a further understanding of the invention and are incorporated in and constitute a part of this application, illustrate embodiment(s) of the invention and together with the description serve to explain the principle of the invention. In the drawings:

(2) FIG. 1 is a perspective view showing a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2 is a front view showing a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;

- (4) FIG. 3 is a side view showing a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (5) FIG. 4 is a view showing a state in which a control panel is separated from a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (6) FIG. 5 is a view showing a control panel coupled to a lower frame in a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (7) FIG. 6 is a view of a control panel viewed from the rear in a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (8) FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view schematically showing a state in which a control panel is coupled to a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (9) FIG. 8 is a view showing a state in which a second front panel and a first side panel are coupled to each other in a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (10) FIG. 9 is a view showing a state in which a second front panel is separated from a first side panel in a laundry treating apparatus in FIG. 8;
- (11) FIG. 10 is a view showing an upper frame in a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (12) FIG. 11 is a view showing an insulating connection member in a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (13) FIG. 12 is a cross-sectional view showing a coupling structure of an insulating connection member in a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (14) FIG. 13 is a perspective view showing a lower frame in a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (15) FIG. 14 is a side view showing a lower frame in a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (16) FIG. 15 is a cross-sectional view of a lower frame and a control panel viewed from the side in a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
- (17) FIG. 16 is a view showing a view of a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure viewed from the rear;
- (18) FIG. 17 is a view showing a rear bracket in a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure; and
- (19) FIG. 18 is a view showing a rear bracket in a laundry treating apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure viewed from the side.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (20) Hereinafter, an embodiment of the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings such that a person having ordinary knowledge in the technical field to which the present disclosure belongs may easily implement the embodiment.
- (21) However, the present disclosure is able to be implemented in various different forms and is not limited to the embodiment described herein. In addition, in order to clearly describe the present disclosure, components irrelevant to the description are omitted in the drawings. Further, similar reference numerals are assigned to similar components throughout the specification.
- (22) Duplicate descriptions of the same components are omitted herein.
- (23) In addition, it will be understood that when a component is referred to as being ‘connected to’ or ‘coupled to’ another component herein, it may be directly connected to or coupled to the other component, or one or more intervening components may be present. On the other hand, it will be understood that when a component is referred to as being ‘directly connected to’ or ‘directly coupled to’ another component herein, there are no other intervening components.
- (24) The terminology used in the detailed description is for the purpose of describing the embodiments of the present disclosure only and is not intended to be limiting of the present disclosure.
- (25) As used herein, the singular forms ‘a’ and ‘an’ are intended to include the plural forms as well,

unless the context clearly indicates otherwise.

(26) It should be understood that the terms ‘comprises’, ‘comprising’, ‘includes’, and ‘including’ when used herein, specify the presence of the features, numbers, steps, operations, components, parts, or combinations thereof described herein, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, numbers, steps, operations, components, or combinations thereof.

(27) In addition, in this specification, the term ‘and/or’ includes a combination of a plurality of listed items or any of the plurality of listed items. In the present specification, ‘A or B’ may include ‘A’, ‘B’, or ‘both A and B’.

(28) FIG. 1 shows a laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the laundry treating apparatus **1** includes a first treating apparatus **10** and a second treating apparatus **20**. The first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** may be in various types for treating laundry, such as a washing machine for washing the laundry or a dryer for drying the laundry.

(29) For example, the first treating apparatus **10** positioned on an upper side in FIG. 1 is a dryer for drying the laundry, which may include a first drum **12** in which the laundry is accommodated disposed therein. The second treating apparatus **20**, which is located on a lower side and supports the first treating apparatus **10**, may correspond to a washing machine for washing the laundry, and may include a second drum **22** in which the laundry is accommodated, and a tub **24** arranged therein. When the second treating apparatus **20** corresponds to the washing machine, the second drum **22** inside the second treating apparatus **20** may be rotatably disposed inside the tub **24**.

(30) However, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** are not necessarily limited to the above types. When necessary, both the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** may be the washing machines or the dryers. In addition, the first treating apparatus **10** may be the washing machine, and the second treating apparatus **20** may be the dryer. The first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** may be various apparatuses for treating the laundry.

(31) The first treating apparatus **10** may include a first cabinet **110** forming an appearance thereof, and the first cabinet **110** may have a first front panel **112** on a front face thereof. A laundry inlet in communication with the first drum **12** may be defined in the first front panel **112**, and the laundry inlet may be opened and closed by a cabinet door.

(32) In addition, the first treating apparatus **10** may include first side panels **115** respectively disposed on both side faces thereof in a left and right direction Y, may include a first rear panel **118** disposed on a rear face thereof, may include a first top panel disposed on a top face thereof, and may include a first bottom panel disposed on a bottom face thereof.

(33) In the present disclosure, the components may have the front and rear directions X parallel to each other, the left and right directions Y parallel to each other, and the vertical directions Z. For example, the front and rear direction X of the first treating apparatus **10** may be defined identically to the front and rear directions X of the second treating apparatus **20**, the control panel **200**, a lower frame **300**, and the like. In addition, the left and right directions Y and the vertical directions Z may also be defined as in the above scheme.

(34) The first front panel **112**, the first side panels **115**, the first rear panel **118**, the first top panel, and the first bottom panel may form the first cabinet **110** together, may have a coupling relationship with each other, and may define a space in which internals constituting the first treating apparatus **10** like the first drum **12** are arranged.

(35) In the first treating apparatus **10**, the laundry requiring the treatment and the like may be inserted into the first cabinet **110** through the laundry inlet and accommodated in the first drum **12**, and a treating process by the first treating apparatus **10** such as washing, drying, and the like may be performed.

(36) According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, FIG. 1 illustrates the first treating apparatus **10** in which the laundry inlet is defined in the first front panel **112** along with the cabinet

door, and the first drum **12** has a rotation axis parallel to a front and rear direction X.

(37) However, the laundry inlet may not be necessarily limited to being defined in the first front panel **112**, and may be defined in the first side panel **115**, the first top panel, or the like together with the cabinet door. For example, the first treating apparatus **10** may be a front loader type or a top loader type.

(38) In one example, the second treating apparatus **20** may include a second cabinet **120** forming an appearance thereof, and the second cabinet **120** may have a second front panel **122** on a front face thereof. A laundry inlet in communication with the second drum **22** may be defined in the second front panel **122**, and the laundry inlet may be opened and closed by a cabinet door.

(39) In addition, the second treating apparatus **20** may have each second side panel **125** on each of both faces thereof in the left and right direction Y, a second rear panel **128** on a rear face thereof, a second top panel on a top face thereof, and a second bottom panel on a bottom face thereof.

(40) The second front panel **122**, the second side panels **125**, the second rear panel **128**, the second top panel, and the second bottom panel may form the second cabinet **120** together, and have a coupling relationship with each other, and define a space in which internals constituting the second treating apparatus **20** such as the second drum **22** and the tub **24** are arranged.

(41) In the second treating apparatus **20**, the laundry requiring the treatment and the like may be inserted into the second cabinet **120** through the laundry inlet and accommodated in the second drum **22**, and a treating process by the second treating apparatus **20** such as the washing, the drying, and the like may be performed.

(42) According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, FIG. **1** illustrates the second treating apparatus **20** in which the laundry inlet is defined in the second front panel **122** along with the cabinet door, and the second drum **22** has a rotation axis parallel to the front and rear direction X.

(43) However, the laundry inlet may not be necessarily limited to being defined in the second front panel **122**, and may be defined in the second side panel **125**, the second top panel, or the like together with the cabinet door. For example, the first treating apparatus **10** may be the front loader type or the top loader type.

(44) For example, the laundry inserted through the first front panel **112** may be accommodated in the first drum **12** to perform the washing, the drying or other treating processes, and the laundry inserted through the second front panel **122** may be accommodated in the second drum **22** to perform the washing, the drying, or other treating processes.

(45) The first treating apparatus **10** may be disposed on the second treating apparatus **20**, and thus, the second treating apparatus **20** may have a structure supporting the first treating apparatus **10** upward. For example, the second top panel of the second treating apparatus **20** may have a structure of directly or indirectly supporting the first bottom panel **119** of the first treating apparatus **10**, and a bottom of the first treating apparatus **10** may be coupled with a top of the second treating apparatus **20**.

(46) In one example, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, each of the first cabinet **110** and the second cabinet **120** may have the front face, the both side faces, the rear face, and the like. In the first cabinet **110**, the first front panel **112** may form the front face of the first cabinet **110**, the first side panels **115** may form the both side faces of the first cabinet **110**, and the first rear panel **118** may form the rear face of the rear face of the first cabinet **110**.

(47) In the second cabinet **120**, the second front panel **122** may form the front face of the second cabinet **120**, the second side panels **125** may form the both side faces of the second cabinet **120**, and the second rear panel **128** may form the rear face of the second cabinet **120**.

(48) In the first cabinet **110**, one of a plurality of faces including the front face, the both side faces, the rear face, and the like may have a length in the vertical direction smaller than those of the other faces. That is, said one of the plurality of faces may have a lower end positioned at a vertical level higher than vertical levels of lower ends of the other faces.

(49) One of the plurality of faces of the second cabinet **120** may protrude upward of the other faces

of the second cabinet **120**. That is, one of the plurality of faces may protrude upward of the other faces. For example, one of the plurality of faces may have an upper end positioned at a vertical level higher than vertical levels of upper ends of the other faces.

(50) That is, one face of each of the first cabinet **110** and the second cabinet **120** may have a length different from lengths of the other faces such that structural interference between the first cabinet **110** and the second cabinet **120** may occur. Therefore, effective coupling between the first cabinet **110** and the second cabinet **120** may be achieved, and arrangement of the first cabinet **110** and the second cabinet **120** may be easily achieved.

(51) For example, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the front face of the second cabinet **120** may have a length in the vertical direction larger than that of the side face. That is, the second cabinet **120** may be constructed such that the front face, for example, the second front panel **122** protrudes upward of the side face. The front face of the second cabinet **120** protruding upwards may extend to invade a region of the first cabinet **110**, thereby acting advantageously for the coupling of the first cabinet **110** and the second cabinet **120** and determination of the position of the first cabinet **110**.

(52) In one example, FIG. **2** shows the laundry treating apparatus **1** shown in FIG. **1** viewed from the front, and FIG. **3** shows the laundry treating apparatus **1** shown in FIG. **1** viewed from the side.

(53) Referring to FIGS. **1** to **2**, in the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, a first laundry inlet **16** that is opened and closed by a first cabinet door **17** and is in communication with the first drum **12** may be defined in the first front panel **112**, and a second laundry inlet **26** that is opened and closed by a second cabinet door **27** and is in communication with the second drum **22** may be defined in the second front panel **122**.

(54) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first treating apparatus **10** may include the first laundry inlet **16** and the first cabinet door **17**, and the first laundry inlet **16** and the first cabinet door **17** may be respectively defined in and disposed on the first front panel **112**. That is, the first treating apparatus **10** may be formed in a front loader shape.

(55) In addition, the second treating apparatus **20** may include the second laundry inlet **26** and the second cabinet door **27**, and the second laundry inlet **26** and the second cabinet door **27** may be respectively defined in and disposed on the second front panel **122**. That is, the second treating apparatus **20** may be formed in the front loader shape.

(56) As a result, the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may be constructed in a form in which the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** in the form of the front loader are stacked in the vertical direction Z. Cross-sections viewed from the above of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** may be designed to be the same or different from each other as necessary.

(57) For example, as will be described later, a length of the first treating apparatus **10** in the front and rear direction X may be smaller than a length of the second treating apparatus **20** in the front and rear direction X. A length of the first treating apparatus **10** in the left and right direction Y and a width of the first treating apparatus **10** may be the same as those of the second treating apparatus **20**.

(58) Sizes and shapes of the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26** may be various. FIG. **2** shows a state in which the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26** are defined in a circle shape and have the same cross-sectional area according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, but the shapes and the cross-sectional areas thereof may be changed as needed.

(59) Sizes and shapes of the first cabinet door **17** and the second cabinet door **27** may also be determined variously to correspond to the sizes and the shapes of the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26**. FIGS. **1** and **2** show the first cabinet door **17** and the second cabinet door **27** having a circular shape and having the same cross-sectional area according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(60) The first cabinet door **17** and the second cabinet door **27** may be constructed to open and close

the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26**, respectively. That is, the first cabinet door **17** and the second cabinet door **27** may be constructed to regulate the opening of the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26**, respectively.

(61) When the first cabinet door **17** and the second cabinet door **27** respectively open the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26**, the user may put the laundry into the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26** as needed, and operate the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** as needed to perform a desired laundry treatment.

(62) There may be various operating types of the first cabinet door **17** and the second cabinet door **27**. For example, the first cabinet door **17** and the second cabinet door **27** may be constructed in a slide form or in a detachable form.

(63) FIGS. **1** and **2** show a state in which one side of each of the first cabinet door **17** and the second cabinet door **27** is hinged to each of the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** to open and close each of the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26**, according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(64) The first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26** may be defined at centers of the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**, respectively, but positions of the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26** may be changed as necessary. The first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26** may be arranged side by side in the vertical direction **Z**.

(65) The first cabinet door **17** and the second cabinet door **27** may also be arranged side by side in the vertical direction **Z**, and may be spaced apart from each other in the vertical direction **Z**. Areas occupied by the first cabinet door **17** and the second cabinet door **27** in the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**, respectively, may be variously determined.

(66) As the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26** are respectively defined in the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**, even when a total height of the laundry treating apparatus **1** is increased, a user may conveniently use the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20**.

(67) In one example, FIGS. **1** to **2** show a state in which the control panel **200** is installed in the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. The laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may include a control panel **200** disposed between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**, and signally connected to the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20**.

(68) The control panel **200** may be disposed between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**. The control panel **200** may be signally connected to at least one of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20**.

(69) The control panel **200** may have a front face **210**, and side faces **240** respectively disposed on both sides thereof in the left and right direction **Y**. The side faces **240** may include a first side face **242** disposed on one side in the left and right direction **Y** and a second side face **244** disposed on the other side.

(70) The control panel **200** may have a top face **220** and a bottom face **230**. The front face **210**, the side faces **240**, the top face **220**, and the bottom face **230** may be connected to each other. For example, the side faces **240**, the top face **220**, and the bottom face **230** may have a shape extending rearward from the front face **210**.

(71) The front face **210** of the control panel **200** may be exposed to the outside to form the front face of the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure together with the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**. The side faces **240** of the control panel **200** may be exposed outside in the left and right direction **Y**, and the top face **220** and the bottom face **230** may be inserted between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** and may not be exposed to the outside.

(72) The control panel **200** may be signally connected to at least one of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20**. The control panel **200** may include a display **213** capable

of indicating states of the first treating apparatus **10** and/or the second treating apparatus **20** disposed on the front face **210**, and may include an input unit capable of inputting an operation command of the first treating apparatus **10** and/or the second treating apparatus **20**.

(73) Electric parts **224** may be arranged inside the control panel **200**, that is, at the rear of the front face **210**. The electric parts **224** may be electrically connected to the first treating apparatus **10** and/or the second treating apparatus **20** and may exchange status information or control signals with the first treating apparatus **10** and/or the second treating apparatus **20**.

(74) For example, the electric parts **224** may include a controller of the first treating apparatus **10** and a controller of the second treating apparatus **20**, may include an integrated controller that controls the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** together, may include a panel controller connected to the controller of the first treating apparatus **10** and the controller of the second treating apparatus **20** in a control manner, or may be controlled by the controller of the first treating apparatus **10** and the controller of the second treating apparatus **20** without a separate controller.

(75) The control panel **200** may include a rear face, but in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the rear face of the control panel **200** may be opened. The control panel **200** disposed between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** may be positioned at a lower portion of the first treating apparatus **10** or at an upper portion of the second treating apparatus **20**.

(76) The control panel **200** may be disposed between the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26**. That is, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the control panel **200** may be disposed between the first cabinet door **17** and the second cabinet door **27**.

(77) As shown in FIGS. **1** to **2**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** may have widths in the left and right direction **Y** the same as or similar to each other. In addition, the control panel **200** may have the same width as the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**.

(78) FIG. **2** shows all of the first front panel **112**, the second front panel **122**, and the control panel **200** having the same width **W** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(79) As the control panel **200** is constructed to have the same width **W** as the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**, an enough internal space for the control panel **200** to be connected to the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** may be secured, and spaces in which a first display **214** and a second display **215** that respectively display the states of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** may be disposed may be easily secured.

(80) As will be described later, the control panel **200** together with the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** may form a front side appearance of the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(81) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the control panel **200** is disposed between the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26**, or between the first cabinet door **17** and the second cabinet door **27**, or between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**, so that a position of the control panel **200** convenient for the user to identify and manipulate the control panel **200** may be secured.

(82) For example, when respective control panels of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** are arranged, because the first treating apparatus **10** is located on the second treating apparatus **20**, the control panel of the first treating apparatus **10** may have an inconvenient position for the user to manipulate.

(83) In addition, because the respective control panels of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** are arranged separately, it may cause inconvenience for the user to manipulate the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** together.

(84) On the other hand, the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure has the single control panel **200** connected to the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** together, which may be convenient for the user to manipulate the first

treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** together.

(85) Furthermore, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, as the control panel **200** is disposed at a position between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**, which is at a vertical level approximately corresponding to a vertical level of a waist of the user, a vertical level convenient for the user to manipulate may be secured.

(86) In addition, in order to secure the vertical level at which ease of use of the user may be improved, as will be described later, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, a vertical level of the second front panel **122** may be higher than a vertical level of the second side panel **125**, that is, the second treating apparatus **20**. Thus, the control panel **200** may have a higher vertical level, so that the ease of use may be further improved.

(87) In addition, as an upper end of the second front panel **122** is positioned at a vertical level higher than that of an upper end of the second side panel **125**, an advantageous structure in the arrangement and the coupling between the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** may be implemented.

(88) In one example, FIGS. **1** to **2** show the second treating apparatus **20** having a detergent opening **28** defined therein according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the second treating apparatus **20** may have the tub **24** disposed therein, and the second drum **22** may be rotatably installed inside the tub **24**.

(89) The second front panel **122** may include the detergent opening **28** defined therein into which a detergent storage unit **30** is inserted, and the detergent opening **28** may be located between the second laundry inlet **26** and the control panel **200**.

(90) That is, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the second treating apparatus **20** may be the washing apparatus in which detergent and wash water are injected into the tub **24** to wash the laundry accommodated in the second drum **22**. The first treating apparatus **10** may be the dryer, the washing machine, or other apparatus for treating the laundry.

(91) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, in the second treating apparatus **20** including the tub **24** disposed therein and into which the wash water and the detergent are injected, a load may be significantly increased. In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the second treating apparatus **20** may be positioned below the first treating apparatus **10** to be supported on the ground.

(92) The second drum **22** may be disposed in the tub **24**, and may be constructed to be rotatable by being directly or indirectly connected to a motor or the like. In addition, an embodiment of the present disclosure may have the front loader type in which the second laundry inlet **26** and the second cabinet door **27** are respectively defined in and disposed on the second front panel **122** as shown in FIGS. **1** and **2**. Therefore, the second drum **22** may have an open front face and may have a rotation axis parallel to the front and rear direction X.

(93) In one example, the second treating apparatus **20** may include the detergent storage unit **30** in which the detergent is stored. The detergent storage unit **30** may be retracted into or extended from the second cabinet **120** through the detergent opening **28**.

(94) For example, the user may separate the detergent storage unit **30** from the second cabinet **120**, store the detergent in the detergent storage unit **30**, and then retract the detergent storage unit **30** into the second cabinet **120** through the detergent opening **28**.

(95) FIGS. **1** and **2** schematically show a state in which the detergent storage unit **30** is inserted into the detergent opening **28** defined in the second front panel **122** of the second treating apparatus **20** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(96) The detergent opening **28** may be located between the second laundry inlet **26** and the control panel **200**. That is, the detergent opening **28** may be positioned above the second laundry inlet **26** and below the control panel **200**.

(97) In the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to the present disclosure, the second treating apparatus **20** may be located below the first treating apparatus **10** and disposed on the ground. Thus, the detergent opening **28** may be positioned above the second laundry inlet **26** to facilitate

the retraction and the extension of the detergent storage unit **30** through the detergent opening **28**.

(98) In addition, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, which is for securing an advantageous position for the user to use the control panel **200**, a distance between the control panel **200** and the first laundry inlet **16** may be the same as a distance between the control panel **200** and the second laundry inlet **26**.

(99) That is, the control panel **200** may be located at a center between the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26** based on the vertical direction. In other words, the control panel **200** may be disposed to have the same distance to the first cabinet door **17** and to the second cabinet door **27**.

(100) Accordingly, the user may use the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26** while at the same time using the control panel **200** having a position that is not biased toward one side, so that the ease of use may be improved.

(101) In one example, as shown in FIGS. **1** to **2**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the second laundry inlet **26** may be defined at a center of the second front panel **122**, the detergent opening **28** may be defined at one side of the upper portion of the second front panel **122**, and the control panel **200** may be located above the detergent opening **28**.

(102) The detergent opening **28** may be defined at the upper end of the second front panel **122**. In addition, the detergent opening **28** may be defined to be biased toward one side of the upper portion of the second front panel **122** in consideration of the shape or the like of the second laundry inlet **26**.

(103) FIGS. **1** and **2** show a state in which the detergent opening **28** is defined to be biased to one side in the left and right direction Y at the upper end of the second front panel **122** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. The detergent opening **28** may be located on a left or right side of the upper portion of the second front panel **122**.

(104) In addition, the control panel **200** may be located above the detergent opening **28**. That is, the detergent opening **28** defined in the second front panel **122** may be positioned below the control panel **200** positioned on the second front panel **122**.

(105) Accordingly, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first laundry inlet **16**, the control panel **200**, the detergent opening **28**, and the second laundry inlet **26** may be arranged in order from the top to the bottom. However, the first laundry inlet **16**, the control panel **200**, the detergent opening **28**, and the second laundry inlet **26** do not necessarily need to be arranged side by side in the vertical direction Z, and there may be a difference in a relative position in the vertical direction Z.

(106) For example, based on the left and right direction Y, the first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26** may be respectively defined at the centers of the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**, but the detergent opening **28** may be positioned to be biased to one side of the second front panel **122**.

(107) However, the detergent opening **28** may be located relatively lower than the first laundry inlet **16** and control panel **200** and may be located relatively upper than the second laundry inlet **26** in the vertical direction Z.

(108) There may be various cross-sectional shapes of the detergent opening **28** viewed from the front, and FIGS. **1** to **2** show the detergent opening **28** having a substantially rectangular cross-section according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(109) In one example, referring to FIGS. **1** and **2**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the second front panel **122** may include a filter opening **29** defined therein into which a filter **40** for collecting foreign substances therein from the wash water is inserted. The filter opening **29** may be defined on one side of a lower portion of the second front panel **122**.

(110) The filter **40** may be retracted into the second cabinet **120** through the filter opening **29** and may be connected to a passage of the wash water discharged from the tub **24**. The filter **40** may filter the foreign substances from the wash water discharged from the tub **24** after the washing

process is performed.

(111) However, the role of the filter **40** may not be necessarily limited thereto, and the filter **40** may be constructed to filter the foreign substances from various objects as needed. For example, the filter **40** may be constructed to filter the foreign substances from the wash water for performing the washing process before proceeding with the washing process.

(112) The user may retract or extend the filter **40** into or from the second cabinet **120** through the filter opening **29**. The extended filter **40** may be reused after washing or redispensed.

(113) The filter **40** may have a relatively longer retraction/extension cycle than the detergent storage unit **30**. Accordingly, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the detergent opening **28** into which the detergent storage unit **30** with a relatively short retraction/extension cycle is retracted may be defined at the upper portion of the second front panel **122**.

(114) In addition, the filter opening **29** into which the filter **40** with the relatively long retraction/extension cycle is retracted may be defined at the lower portion of the second front panel **122**, thereby implementing a structure of the second front panel **122** that improves the ease of use and has excellent space utilization.

(115) Furthermore, the wash water discharge passage defined inside the second cabinet **120** and connected to the tub **24** may be located at a lower portion within the second cabinet **120** to facilitate discharge of the wash water. In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the filter **40** and the filter opening **29** may be respectively disposed and defined at the lower portion of the second front panel **122** to be efficiently connected to the wash water discharge passage.

(116) In one example, the filter opening **29** may also be positioned to be biased to one side in the left and right direction Y of the second front panel **122** in consideration of securing the shape and the area of the second laundry inlet **26** like the detergent opening **28**.

(117) FIGS. **1** to **2** show the detergent opening **28** and the filter opening **29** defined to be biased toward one side in the left and right direction Y of the second front panel **122** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(118) The detergent opening **28** and the filter opening **29** may be defined to be biased to one side or the other side around a center of the second laundry inlet **26** based on the left and right direction Y, for example, to a left or right side, and may be defined side by side in the vertical direction Z.

(119) However, the detergent opening **28** and the filter opening **29** do not necessarily need to be biased to one side in the left and right direction Y. The detergent opening **28** may be biased to one side in the left and right direction Y and the filter opening **29** may be biased to the other side in the left and right direction Y.

(120) Referring to FIG. **2**, in the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first laundry inlet **16**, the control panel **200**, the detergent opening **28**, the second laundry inlet **26**, and the filter openings **29** may be arranged in order from top to bottom.

(121) The above described components may not be necessarily need to be aligned side by side in the vertical direction Z, and a vertical positional relationship thereof may be defined in a relative relationship thereof. For example, the filter opening **29** may not be defined vertically below the center of the second laundry inlet **26**, but may be defined relatively below the center of the second laundry inlet **26**.

(122) In one example, the detergent storage unit **30** inserted into the detergent opening **28** may have a front face forwardly exposed to form one face together with the second front panel **122**. That is, the front face of the detergent storage unit **30** may be located on one face together with the second front panel **122**.

(123) The detergent storage unit **30** having the front face flush with an outer face of the second front panel **122** may form a front appearance of the second treating apparatus **20** together with the second front panel **122**. FIGS. **1** to **2** show a state in which the front face of the detergent storage unit **30** is flush with the outer face of the second front panel **122** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. A handle may be formed on the front face of the detergent storage unit **30** to

facilitate gripping of the user.

(124) Referring to FIG. 2, when viewing the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure from the front, the control panel **200** may be disposed on the second front panel **122**, and the first front panel **112** is disposed on the control panel **200**. The first front panel **112**, the control panel **200**, and the second front panel **122** may have the same width, the center of the first laundry inlet **16** may be located at the center of the first front panel **112**, and the center of the second laundry inlet **26** may be located at the center of the second front panel **122**. The first laundry inlet **16** and the second laundry inlet **26** may have the same shape and may be aligned side by side in the vertical direction Z.

(125) In addition, in the second front panel **122**, the detergent opening **28** may be located above the second laundry inlet **26**, but may be located below the control panel **200**. The detergent opening **28** may be positioned to be biased to one side at the upper portion of the second front panel **122**, the filter opening **29** may be located below the second laundry inlet **26**, the filter opening **29** may be located to be biased to one side at the lower portion of the second front panel **122**, and the detergent opening **28** and the filter opening **29** may be positioned side by side in the vertical direction Z.

(126) In one example, referring to FIG. 3, in the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the upper end of the second front panel **122** may be located in front of the first side panels **115** to support the first side panels **115** rearwardly.

(127) That is, the second front panel **122** may be disposed such that the upper end thereof protrudes upward of the second treating apparatus **20**. In other words, the upper end of the second front panel **122** may be positioned at a vertical level higher than that of the upper end of the second side panel **125** to support the lower portion of the first side panel **115** rearwardly.

(128) In addition, the control panel **200** may be positioned on the upper end protruding upward of the second treating apparatus **20**, and the lower end of the first front panel **112** may be positioned at a vertical level higher than that of the lower end of the first treating apparatus **10**.

(129) For example, as shown in FIG. 3, the control panel **200** may be disposed on a front face of the lower portion of the first treating apparatus **10**, and may upwardly face the first front panel **112** and downwardly face the second front panel **122**.

(130) Specifically, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, in the second treating apparatus **20**, the second front panel **122** may have a height in the vertical direction Z larger than a height of the second side panel **125** in the vertical direction Z. The lower end of the second front panel **122** and the lower end of the second side panel **125** may be located at the same vertical level, and therefore, the upper end of the second front panel **122** may protrude upwards from the second side panel **125** or the second treating apparatus **20**, and may be located on a front face of the first treating apparatus **10**.

(131) Accordingly, a portion of the second front panel **122** may define a portion of the front face of the first treating apparatus **10**. The upper end of the second front panel **122** may be located in front of the first side panels **115** of the first treating apparatus **10**, and thus, the second front panel **122** may support the first side panels **115** rearwardly.

(132) FIG. 3 shows a height H1 of the upper end of the second front panel **122** protruding upward from the second treating apparatus **20**. The height H1 of the upper end of the second front panel **122** may be variously determined as necessary.

(133) In the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** are manufactured independently of each other and may be assembled together in a space of use. In this connection, the second treating apparatus **20** may be disposed on the ground of the space of use, and then, the first treating apparatus **10** may be disposed on the second treating apparatus **20**.

(134) When the first treating apparatus **10** is stacked on the second treating apparatus **20** as above, the upper end of the second front panel **122** may serve as means for guiding a correct coupling position of the first treating apparatus **10**.

(135) For example, when a worker slides the first treating apparatus **10** forward in the state in which the first treating apparatus **10** is approximately positioned on the second treating apparatus **20**, the bottom of the first treating apparatus **10** may be in contact with the upper end of the located second front panel **122**, and thus, an optimal fastening position of the first treating apparatus **10** may be determined at least based on the front and rear direction X.

(136) Furthermore, in the state in which the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** are fastened with each other to be stacked together, the upper end of the second front panel **122** supports the first treating apparatus **10** rearward, so that the stable coupling may be maintained.

(137) In one example, the second front panel **122** may be constructed to be longer in the vertical direction than the second side panel **125**. That is, the second front panel **122** may be constructed with the upper end located at the vertical level higher than the vertical level of the upper end of the second side panel **125** such that the upper end of the second front panel **122** may protrude upward without harming an overall design of the second treating apparatus **20**.

(138) The upper end of the second side panel **125** may correspond to the upper end of the second treating apparatus **20**. Therefore, an embodiment of the present disclosure may increase only the length of the second front panel **122** in the vertical direction while maintaining numeric values in design of other panels in the second treating apparatus **20**.

(139) For example, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, even when the height of the second front panel **122** increases, the detergent opening **28** of the second treating apparatus **20** may be located at a vertical level lower than that of the upper end of the second side panel **125**. That is, an embodiment of the present disclosure may increase only the height of the second front panel **122** while maintaining the position of the detergent opening **28** or the length in the vertical direction of the second side panel **125** as it is.

(140) Accordingly, as described above, in a situation in which the first treating apparatus **10** is stacked on the second treating apparatus **20**, the second front panel **122** may serve as a stopper capable of determining the position of the first treating apparatus **10**, and at the same time, may increase a vertical level from the ground of the control panel **200** disposed on the second front panel **122** to secure a position of the control panel **200** to be conveniently used by the user.

(141) For example, when the second front panel **122** has a larger height than the second side panel **125**, the vertical level of the control panel **200** may become relatively higher than that in contrast to a case of placing the control panel **200** between the second front panel **122** having the same height as the second side panel **125** and the first front panel **112**. Accordingly, a position more convenient for the user to manipulate the control panel **200** using a hand or to visually identify the display **213** may be provided.

(142) In one example, the lower end of the first front panel **112** may be constructed to be positioned at a vertical level higher than that of the lower end of the first treating apparatus **10** or the lower end of the first side panel **115** such that the upper end of the second front panel **122** and the control panel **200** may be arranged on the front face of the first treating apparatus **10**.

(143) The upper end of the first front panel **112** may be located at the same vertical level as the upper end of the first side panel **115**, and thus, the height or the length in the vertical direction Z of the first front panel **112** may be smaller than the height or the length in the vertical direction Z of the first side panel **115**.

(144) As the lower end of the first front panel **112** is located at the vertical level higher than that of the lower end of the first side panel **115** or the upper end of the second side panel **125**, a lower portion of the front face of the first cabinet **110** may be forwardly opened or exposed, and the opened lower portion may be shielded by the control panel **200** and the upper end of the second front panel **122**.

(145) The upper end of the second front panel **122** may be located below the first front panel **112** and in front of the first side panels **115**. The first side panels **115** may be forwardly exposed to form

a coupling relationship with the second treating apparatus **20** by the position of the lower end of the first front panel **112**, or arrangement of the first side panels **115** and the second treating apparatus **20** may be easily induced by the second front panel **122**.

(146) As the lower end of the first front panel **112** is spaced upwardly apart from the upper end of the second front panel **122**, a space may be defined between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**, and the control panel **200** may be disposed in the space.

(147) The control panel **200** may be upwardly connected to the first front panel **112** and downwardly connected to the second front panel **122**. That is, the first front panel **112**, the control panel **200**, and the second front panel **122** may form the front face of the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, and the first front panel **112**, the control panel **200**, and the upper end of the second front panel **122** may form the front face of the first treating apparatus **10**.

(148) The vertical level of the first front panel **112** or the position of the lower end of the first front panel **112** may be variously determined based on the vertical level of the control panel **200** and the vertical level of the upper end of the second front panel **122**.

(149) In one example, in the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to the present disclosure, the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** may have different lengths in the vertical direction Z.

(150) Referring to FIG. 3, the length in the vertical direction Z, that is, the height H3 of the second front panel **122** whose upper end is located on the lower front face of the first treating apparatus **10** may be larger than the length in the vertical direction Z, that is, the height of the second cabinet **120** forming the appearance of the second treating apparatus **20**.

(151) In addition, the length in the vertical direction Z, that is, the height H2 of the first front panel **112** whose lower end is disposed to be spaced upwardly from the second front panel **122** may be smaller than the length in the vertical direction Z, that is, the height of the first cabinet **110** or the first side panel **115** forming the appearance of the first treating apparatus **10**.

(152) As above, the first front panel **112** whose height is reduced such that the lower front face of the first treating apparatus **10** is opened, and the second front panel **122** whose height is increased such that the upper end thereof is located on the lower front face of the first treating apparatus **10** may be designed to have different heights.

(153) Further, the length in the vertical direction Z, that is, the height H3 of the second front panel **122** may be larger than the length in the vertical direction Z, that is, the height H2 of the first front panel **112**. A deviation between the height H2 of the first front panel **112** and the height H3 of the second front panel **122** or specific values of H2 and H3 may be variously determined as necessary.

(154) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the height H2 of the first front panel **112** is smaller than the height H3 of the second front panel **122**, so that a structure in which the upper end of the second front panel **122** is located on the lower front face of the first treating apparatus **10** to rearwardly support the first treating apparatus **10**, and the lower end of the first front panel **112** is spaced upwardly apart from the second front panel **122** may be effectively implemented.

(155) In one example, referring to FIG. 3, the control panel **200** may be inserted in the space defined as the lower end of the first front panel **112** is spaced upwardly apart from the upper end of the second front panel **122**.

(156) That is, the control panel **200** may be inserted between the lower end of the first front panel **112** and the upper end of the second front panel **122** to be positioned at the lower front face of the first treating apparatus **10**. As described above, the control panel **200** may be disposed between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**, so that the ease of use of the user may be improved.

(157) In one example, as shown in FIG. 3, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the front face **210** of the control panel **200** that is disposed between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** and is forwardly exposed may be flush with the first front panel **112** and the second

front panel **122** in the vertical direction **Z**.

(158) That is, the front face **210** of the control panel **200** may be positioned on one face together with the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**. The first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** may form one face connected through the front face **210**, and the control panel **200** may be connected to the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** to form one face.

(159) The first front panel **112**, the second front panel **122**, and the front face **210** of the control panel **200** may together form the front face of the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. In addition, as shown in FIG. **2**, the front face **210** of the control panel **200** may extend along the left and right direction **Y** to have the width **W** corresponding to widths of the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**.

(160) In one example, FIG. **4** is a perspective view showing a state in which the control panel **200** is separated from the laundry treating apparatus **1** in an embodiment of the present disclosure. Referring to FIGS. **2** and **4**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the front face **210** of the control panel **200** may include the first display **214** and the second display **215**.

(161) The first display **214** may indicate the operating state of the first treating apparatus **10**, and the second display **215** may indicate the operating state of the second treating apparatus **20**.

(162) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the user may monitor the operating states of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** and control the operating states through the single control panel **200**.

(163) The front face **210** of the control panel **200** may have the display **213** for visually identifying the operating states of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20**, and the display **213** may include the first display **214** indicating the state of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second display **215** indicating the state of the second treating apparatus **20**.

(164) The first display **214** and the second display **215** may be formed in various shapes. For example, as shown in FIGS. **2** and **4**, the first display **214** and the second display **215** may be in a form of being separated and spaced apart from each other or may respectively indicate different information on an integrated region.

(165) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first display **214** indicating the state of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second display **215** indicating the state of the second treating apparatus **20** are arranged together on the single control panel **200**, so that the user may easily identify the states of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20**, and may manipulate the manipulation unit to easily control the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20**.

(166) The manipulation unit may be formed in an integrated form for manipulating the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** together, or may include a first manipulation unit for manipulating the first treating apparatus **10** and a second manipulation unit for manipulating the second treating apparatus.

(167) In one example, FIG. **5** shows the control panel **200** coupled with the lower frame **300** to be described later, and FIG. **6** shows a perspective view of the control panel **200** viewed from the rear, and FIG. **7** shows a cross-section of the control panel **200** coupled with the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**.

(168) Referring to FIGS. **4** to **7**, in the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the control panel **200** may be fixed as the upper portion of the control panel **200** is coupled to the lower portion of the first front panel **112**, and the lower portion of the control panel **200** is coupled to the upper portion of the second front panel **122**.

(169) For example, in the control panel **200**, the top face **220** extending rearward from the upper end of the front face **210** may be coupled to the first front panel **112**, that is, the lower portion of the first front panel **112**, and the bottom face **230** extending rearward from the lower end of the front face **210** may be coupled to the second front panel **122**, that is, the upper portion of the

second front panel **122**.

(170) The control panel **200** may form a stable coupling structure as the top face **220** and the bottom face **230** thereof are respectively coupled to the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**. In addition, as will be described later, the side faces **240** of the control panel **200** may be coupled to the lower frame **300**, thereby improving coupling stability.

(171) There may be various schemes for the control panel **200** to be coupled with the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**. For example, the control panel **200** may move from a position in front of the first treating apparatus **10** toward the first treating apparatus **10** and be inserted between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**. In the insertion process of the control panel **200**, panel fastening portions **260** that may be respectively disposed on the top face **220** and the bottom face **230** may be respectively coupled to the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** as will be described later.

(172) Referring to FIG. 7, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the second front panel **122** may include an upper end bent portion **123** extending rearward from the upper end of the front face **133**.

(173) The upper end bent portion **123** may be formed by being bent from the front face **133** of the second front panel **122**. That is, the upper end bent portion **123** may be formed by being bent rearward from the upper end of the second front panel **122**.

(174) The upper portion of the control panel **200** may be coupled to the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112**, and the lower portion of the control panel **200** may be coupled to the upper end bent portion **123** of the second front panel **122**.

(175) Specifically, the control panel **200** inserted between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** has the top, that is, the top face **220** facing toward the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112**, and the bottom, that is, the bottom face **230** facing toward the upper end bent portion **123** of the second front panel **122**.

(176) The top face **220** of the control panel **200** may be disposed in parallel with the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112**, and the bottom face **230** of the control panel **200** may be disposed in parallel with the upper end bent portion **123** of the second front panel **122**.

Furthermore, the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112** and the upper end bent portion **123** of the second front panel **122** may also be arranged in parallel with each other.

(177) The top face **220** of the control panel **200** may be coupled to the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112**, and the bottom face **230** of the control panel **200** may be coupled to the upper end bent portion **123** of the second front panel **122**.

(178) The upper end bent portion **123** of the second front panel **122** whose upper end is positioned at the lower front face of the first treating apparatus **10** may be positioned at a vertical level higher than that of the upper end of the second side panel **125** to support the bottom, that is, the bottom face **230** of the control panel **200**.

(179) In addition, the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112** whose lower end is spaced upwardly apart from the second front panel **122** will be supported by the top, that is, the top face **220** of the control panel **200**.

(180) That is, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first front panel **112**, the control panel **200**, and the second front panel **122** may form a mutual support structure in the vertical direction Z through the upper end bent portion **123**, the bottom face **230**, the top face **220**, and the lower end bent portion **113**, thereby improving the structural stability of the laundry treating apparatus **1**.

(181) In one example, FIG. 5 shows the panel fastening portion **260** disposed on the top face **220** of the control panel **200**, and FIG. 6 shows the panel fastening portion **260** disposed on the bottom face **230** of the control panel **200**. FIG. 7 schematically shows a cross-section of the panel fastening portions **260** respectively disposed on the top face **220** and the bottom face **230** of the control panel **200** and respectively coupled to the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112** and the

upper end bent portion **123** of the second front panel **122**.

(182) Referring to FIGS. 5 to 7, the top face **220** and the bottom face **230** may respectively include the panel fastening portions **260** respectively disposed thereon and respectively penetrating and coupled to the lower end bent portion **113** and the upper end bent portion **123** respectively facing thereto.

(183) The panel fastening portion **260** may be formed in shape of a hook and coupled to the lower end bent portion **113** or the upper end bent portion **123**, and may be formed in a shape of a protrusion and inserted into and coupled to the lower end bent portion **113** or the upper end bent portion **123**.

(184) FIGS. 5 to 7 show the panel fastening portions **260** respectively inserted into and coupled to the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112** and the upper end bent portion **123** of the second front panel **122** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. The number, positions, and shapes of the panel fastening portion **260** may be various as needed.

(185) In one example, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, each of the top face **220** and the bottom face **230** may include an opening **262** open in the vertical direction Z and a fastening elastic portion **265** extending from an inner face of the opening **262** to intersect the opening **262**. The panel fastening portion **260** of each of the top face **220** and the bottom face **230** may be disposed on the fastening elastic portion **265**.

(186) Specifically, a top face opening **263** may be defined in the top face **220** and a bottom face opening **264** may be defined in the bottom face **230**. Each of the top face opening **263** and the bottom face opening **264** may have a shape open in the vertical direction Z and may penetrate each of the top face **220** and the bottom face **230**.

(187) The fastening elastic portion **265** may include a top face fastening elastic portion **266** disposed on the top face **220** and a bottom face fastening elastic portion **267** disposed on the bottom face **230**. The top face fastening elastic portion **266** may be disposed to intersect the top face opening **263** of the top face **220**, and the bottom face fastening elastic portion **267** may be disposed to intersect the bottom face opening **264** of the bottom face **230**.

(188) The fastening elastic portion **265** may extend in parallel with the top face **220** or the bottom face **230** from the inner face of each opening **262**. For example, the fastening elastic portion **265** may extend from one side of the inner face of the opening **262** and may be connected to the other side of the inner face of the opening **262**.

(189) That is, the fastening elastic portion **265** may be disposed on the opening **262**. Both ends of the fastening elastic portion **265** are connected to the top face **220** or the bottom face **230** of the control panel **200** in a longitudinal direction, and the remaining portion thereof is separated from the top face **220** or the bottom face **230**.

(190) Each opening **262** may have a shape extending in parallel with the longitudinal direction of the fastening elastic portion **265**, and may be at least partially shielded in the vertical direction Z by the fastening elastic portion **265**.

(191) For example, the fastening elastic portion **265** may be formed by cutting both sides thereof from the top face **220** or the bottom face **230** along the longitudinal direction of the fastening elastic portion **265**.

(192) Accordingly, the both ends of the fastening elastic portion **265** connected to the inner face of the opening **262** are fixed, so that a center of the fastening elastic portion **265** may be separated from the top face **220** or the bottom face **230** and be elastically deformed.

(193) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, as the panel fastening portion **260** is disposed on the fastening elastic portion **265**, in a process in which each panel fastening portion **260** is moved toward the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112** or the upper end bent portion **123** of the second front panel **122**, the fastening elastic portion **265** is pressed and deformed. Further, the fastening elastic portion **265** is restored as the panel fastening portion **260** reaches each coupling point, so that the coupling structure may be formed.

(194) In one example, FIG. 5 shows a panel support **268** disposed on the top face **220** of the control panel **200** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. The panel support **268** may be distinguished from the panel fastening portion **260**, and an upper end of the panel support **268** may upwardly support the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112**. The number and a shape of the panel supports **268** may be various, and the panel support **268** may have a top face in parallel with the lower end bent portion **113**.

(195) The panel support **268** may protrude upward from the top face **220** of the control panel **200** like the panel fastening portion **260**. However, unlike the panel fastening portion **260** inserted into the lower end bent portion **113**, the panel support **268** may be in contact with the bottom face of the lower end bent portion **113** to support the lower end bent portion **113**. The panel support **268** may have a protrusion shape like the panel fastening portion **260**.

(196) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, as the panel support **268** supporting the bottom of the first front panel **112** is disposed on the top face **220** of the control panel **200**, the first front panel **112** may be stably supported. Furthermore, because the panel support **268** of the control panel **200** supports the first front panel **112** together with the top support **356** of the lower frame **300**, structural stability may be improved.

(197) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the panel fastening portion **260** may have a protrusion height greater than that of the panel support **268**. Accordingly, an entirety of the lower end bent portion **113** may have a flat face, and a structure in which the panel fastening portion **260** is inserted into the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112**, and the panel support **268** supports the lower end bent portion **113** may be realized.

(198) In one example, each of the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** may include each of the front faces **131** and **133** exposed forward of the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, and may include side end bent portions **135** respectively extending rearward from both ends in the left and right direction Y of each of the front faces **131** and **133**.

(199) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the side end bent portions **135** may include first side end bent portions **136** arranged on the first front panel **112** and second side end bent portions **137** arranged on the second front panel **122**. FIGS. 1, 3, and 4 show the first side end bent portions **136** and the second side end bent portions **137** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(200) The front face **131** of the first front panel **112** may be exposed forwardly of the first treating apparatus **10**, and the first side end bent portions **136** may be respectively disposed at both ends in the left and right direction Y of the first front panel **112**. The front face **133** of the second front panel **122** may be exposed forwardly of the second treating apparatus **20**, and the second side end bent portions **137** may be respectively disposed at both ends in the left and right direction Y of the second front panel **122**.

(201) Each side end bent portion **135** may be formed by being bent to extend rearward from each of the front faces **131** and **133** of the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**. That is, the first side end bent portions **136** may be formed integrally with the front face **131** of the first front panel **112** and bent rearward from the front face **131** of the first front panel **112**, and the second side end bent portions **137** may be formed integrally with the front face **133** of the second front panel **122** and bent rearward from the front face **133** of the second front panel **122**.

(202) In one example, the side end bent portions **135** of the second front panel **122**, that is, the second side end bent portion **137**, have upper ends positioned at a vertical level higher than that of the upper end of the second side panel **125**, so that the second side end bent portions **137** may support the first side panels **115** rearwardly.

(203) The second side end bent portions **137** may have the same height as the front face **133** of the second front panel **122**. That is, the upper end of the second front panel **122** may include the upper ends of the second side end bent portions **137**. Therefore, as shown in FIG. 3, the upper end of the

second front panel **122** may be located at the vertical level higher than that of the second side panels **125**, and the upper ends of the second side end bent portions **137** may also be located at the vertical level higher than that of the second side panel **125**.

(204) That is, in the second front panel **122**, the second side end bent portions **137** may be respectively in contact with the first side panels **115** of the first treating apparatus **10** to support the first side panels **115** rearwardly.

(205) In one example, the first side panel **115** and the second side panel **125** may be arranged side by side such that front ends thereof are aligned in a line along the vertical direction Z. In addition, a rear end of the side end bent portion **135** of the second front panel **122** may be constructed to be in contact with the front ends of the first side panel **115** and the second side panel **125** together.

(206) In addition, as described above, the side faces **240** extending rearward may be respectively disposed on both sides in the left and right direction Y of the front face **210** of the control panel **200**. The side face **240** may be disposed between the first side end bent portion **136** and the second side end bent portion **137** and be positioned side by side with the first side end bent portion **136** and the second side end bent portion **137** in the vertical direction Z.

(207) Referring to FIG. **1**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the front face **131** of the first front panel **112**, the front face **133** of the second front panel **122**, and the front face **210** of the control panel **200** may be aligned side by side on the front face of the laundry treating apparatus **1**.

(208) In addition, the first side end bent portion **136**, the second side end bent portion **137**, and the side face **240** of the control panel **200** may be arranged side by side on the side face of the laundry treating apparatus **1**. That is, the side face **240** may be arranged side by side with the first side end bent portion **136** and the second side end bent portion **137** in the vertical direction.

(209) In one example, the side face **240** of the control panel **200**, the first side end bent portion **136**, the second side end bent portion **137**, the first side panel **115**, and the second side panel **125** may be arranged side by side on the side face of the laundry treating apparatus **1**. The second side end bent portion **137** may be located in front of the first side panel **115** and may be aligned side by side with the first side panel **115** in the front and rear direction X.

(210) Specifically, the first side panel **115** and the second side panel **125** may be aligned side by side in the vertical direction Z to form one face. The first side panel **115** and the first side end bent portion **136** may be aligned side by side in the front and rear direction X to form one face. The second side panel **125** and the second side end bent portion **137** may be aligned side by side in the front and rear direction X to form one face.

(211) In addition, the first side end bent portion **136**, the second side end bent portion **137**, and the side face **240** of the control panel **200** may be aligned side by side in the vertical direction Z to form one face. Eventually, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the side face **240** of the control panel **200**, the first side end bent portion **136**, the second side end bent portion **137**, the first side panel **115**, and the second side panel **125** may be aligned side by side together to form one face, that is, the side face of the laundry treating apparatus **1**.

(212) In one example, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the second front panel **122** may further include an upper end fastening portion **124**. FIG. **4** shows the upper end fastening portion **124** of the second front panel **122** coupled to the first treating apparatus **10**.

(213) Referring to FIG. **4**, the upper end fastening portion **124** may extend upward from the upper end bent portion **123** of the second front panel **122** and may be coupled to the first treating apparatus **10**. In the second front panel **122**, the upper end fastening portion **124** may be coupled to the first treating apparatus **10**, thereby securing the coupling stability.

(214) As will be described later, the upper end fastening portion **124** may be penetrated by a second fastening member **472** together with the upper frame **400** and be fastened to a second fastening hole **470**.

(215) Referring to FIG. **4**, the upper end fastening portion **124** may be disposed above the second front panel **122**, and the upper end fastening portion **124** may be disposed on the upper end bent

portion **123** of the second front panel **122**. That is, the upper end fastening portion **124** may have a shape extending upward from a rear end of the upper end bent portion **123** extending rearward from the upper end of the second front panel **122**.

(216) The upper end bent portion **123** may be bent rearward from the upper end of the second front panel **122**, and the upper end fastening portion **124** may be bent upward from the rear end of the upper end bent portion **123**.

(217) The upper end fastening portion **124** may have the same width as the widths of the front face **133** of the second front panel **122** and the upper end bent portion **123**, or a plurality of fastening portions **124** with a width smaller than that of the upper end bent portion **123** may be aligned with each other along a width direction. FIG. 4 shows a state in which the upper end fastening portions **124** are respectively disposed on both sides in the width direction of the upper end bent portion **123** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(218) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, both sides in the left and right direction Y of the upper end fastening portion **124** may be respectively fastened to the first side panels **115** respectively facing thereto. That is, in the upper end fastening portion **124**, a portion overlapping the first side panel **115** in the front and rear direction X may be coupled to the first side panel **115**. For example, portions of the upper end fastening portion **124** respectively extending upward from the both sides in the left and right direction Y of the upper end bent portion **123** may be respectively coupled to the first side panels **115**.

(219) In one example, FIG. 8 shows the upper end fastening portion **124** coupled to the first side panel **115**, and FIG. 9 shows the upper end fastening portion **124** separated from the first side panel **115**.

(220) Referring to FIGS. 8 and 9, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, each first side panel **115** may include a front end bent portion **116** in the front, and each upper end fastening portion **124** of the second front panel **122** may be fastened to the front end bent portions **116** of each first side panel **115**.

(221) The front end bent portion **116** may be constructed to extend in the left and right direction Y from a front end of the first side panel **115**, and may be formed by being bent from the side face **138** of the first side panel **115** forming the side face of the first treating apparatus **10**.

(222) The front end bent portion **116** may extend along the left and right direction Y of the first treating apparatus **10** toward the interior of the first treating apparatus **10**. That is, the first side panel **115** disposed on one side in the left and right direction Y of the first treating apparatus **10** may include a front end bent portion **116** extending toward the other side in the left and right direction Y, and the first side panel **115** disposed on the other side in the left and right direction Y of the first treating apparatus **10** may include a front end bent portion **116** extending toward one side in the left and right direction Y.

(223) The front end bent portion **116** may have a face parallel to the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**. That is, the front end bent portion **116** may be formed in a plate shape parallel to the first front panel **112**, the second front panel **122**, and the front face **210** of the control panel **200**.

(224) In one example, the upper end fastening portion **124** extending upward from the upper end bent portion **123** of the second front panel **122** may also be formed in a plate shape parallel to the front end bent portion **116**. Each upper end fastening portion **124** may be fastened to each front end bent portion **116** disposed parallel to each upper end fastening portion **124**, and a fastening scheme may be various such as using a fastening member as will be described below.

(225) In addition, the front face **210** of the control panel **200** is positioned parallel to the front face **133** of the second front panel **122** in the vertical direction Z, and the upper end fastening portion **124** is disposed on the upper end bent portion **123** extending rearward from the second front panel **122**, so that the upper end fastening portion **124** may be located at the rear of the front face **210** of the control panel **200**.

(226) That is, each upper end fastening portion **124** may be positioned between the control panel **200** and the front end bent portion **116** of each first side panel **115**. Thus, each upper end fastening portion **124** may be coupled to the front end bent portion **116** of each first side panel **115** at the rear of the front face **210**, and a coupling structure between the first side panel **115** and the upper end fastening portion **124** may be shielded from the outside by the control panel **200**. FIG. 7 shows the upper end fastening portion **124** positioned at the rear of the front face **210** of the control panel **200**.

(227) In one example, referring to FIG. 7, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the upper end fastening portion **124** may be positioned at the rear of the bottom face **230** of the control panel **200**. That is, the bottom face **230** may extend such that a rear end thereof is positioned in front of the upper end fastening portion **124**. Accordingly, the control panel **200** is inserted between and coupled to the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** at a position in front of the upper end fastening portion **124**, so that structural interference between the control panel **200** and the upper end fastening portions **124** may be avoided.

(228) In addition, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the side face **240** of the control panel **200** is extended such that the rear end thereof is positioned at the rear of the bottom face **230** to face toward the first side panel **115**.

(229) That is, an extended length of the side face **240** from the front face **210** may be larger than an extended length of the bottom face **230** from the front face **210**. The bottom face **230** of the control panel **200** has a rear end positioned in front of the upper end fastening portion **124** in order to exclude structural interference with the upper end fastening portion **124** and the like, and the side face **240** may extend such that the rear end thereof is in contact with the first side panel **115** in order to shield the interior of the control panel **200** from the outside.

(230) FIG. 6 shows the side faces **240** whose extended length along the front and rear direction X is larger than that of the bottom face **230** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(231) In one example, FIG. 9 shows the upper frame **400** disposed between the upper end fastening portion **124** and the first side panel **115** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, and FIG. 10 is a view of the upper frame **400** coupled to the first treating apparatus **10** viewed from the front.

(232) Referring to FIGS. 9 and 10, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the second treating apparatus **20** may include the upper frame **400**, the upper frame **400** may be disposed between the second front panel **122** and each second side panel **125** and coupled to each second side panel **125**, and upper end of the upper frame **400** positioned above the second side panels **125** may be coupled to the front end bent portions **116** together with the upper end fastening portions **124**.

(233) That is, in the upper frame **400**, each lower end may be positioned between the second front panel **122** and each second side panel **125**, and the upper end may protrude upward of the second side panels **125**.

(234) Specifically, the upper frame **400** may be positioned on an upper portion of the front face of the second treating apparatus **20**, and may be coupled to the second side panels **125** of the second treating apparatus **20**, and the like. In addition, the upper frame **400** may be constructed to be coupled to the first treating apparatus **10** to fasten the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** to each other.

(235) The upper frame **400** is disposed on the rear face of the second front panel **122**, and may be disposed in front of the second top panel and the second side panels **125** of the second treating apparatus **20** as shown in FIG. 17. That is, the upper frame **400** may be disposed between the second front panel **122** and each second side panel **125**.

(236) The upper frame **400** may be coupled to the second side panels **125** on the both sides in the left and right direction Y, and may be forwardly coupled to the second front panel **122**. The upper frame **400** may contribute to improving structural stability and rigidity of the upper portion of the second treating apparatus **20**.

(237) The upper frame **400** may be fixed to the second treating apparatus **20**, and the upper portion

of the upper frame **400** extending upwards may be coupled to the lower portion of the first treating apparatus **10**. The upper frame **400** may have a face parallel to the second front panel **122** and may be disposed on the front face of the second treating apparatus **20**.

(238) The upper portion of the upper frame **400** may be coupled to the front end bent portions **116** of the first side panels **115**. The upper frame **400** may be coupled to the front end bent portions **116** of the first side panels **115** together with the upper end fastening portions **124** of the second front panel **122**.

(239) That is, the upper end fastening portion **124** may be disposed at the upper end of the second front panel **122** and may be coupled to the first treating apparatus **10**. The upper end fastening portion **124** may be disposed to cover the upper frame **400** from the front, that is, covers the front face of the upper frame **400**, and may be coupled to the first treating apparatus **10** together with the upper frame **400**.

(240) The upper frame **400** may be formed in a plate shape having a face parallel to the front face **133** of the second front panel **122**, and may be disposed between the second front panel **122** and each second side panel **125** in the second treating apparatus **20** to be coupled to each second side panel **125**. The upper portion of the upper frame **400** protruding upward of the second treating apparatus **20** may be disposed between each upper end fastening portion **124** of the second front panel **122** and the front end bent portion **116** of each first side panel **115**, and be coupled to the front end bent portion **116** of each first side panel **115**. The upper frame **400** may be coupled to the front end bent portions **116** together with the upper end fastening portions **124**.

(241) In one example, FIG. **8** shows a state in which each upper end fastening portion **124** and the upper frame **400** are coupled to each first side panel **115** through each insulating connection member **450**, and FIG. **9** shows a state in which each upper end fastening portion **124**, the upper frame **400**, and each insulating connection member **450** are separated from each other.

(242) As shown in FIGS. **8** and **9**, the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may include each insulating connection member **450** disposed between the upper frame **400** and each front end bent portion **116** to insulate the upper frame **400** and each upper end fastening portion **124** from each front end bent portion **116**.

(243) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** may correspond to apparatuses that are independent of each other, and may respectively have components that use electricity, such as the motor, the controller, or the like, therein.

(244) When a situation in which the electricity leaks from one of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** occurs, it is necessary to prevent the leaked electricity from affecting the other.

(245) That is, the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** need to be electrically insulated from each other, so that electric leakage does not occur therebetween.

(246) Accordingly, an embodiment of the present disclosure may use the insulating connection member **450** for fastening the upper frame **400** of the second treating apparatus **20** with the first treating apparatus **10**, and the upper frame **400** may be connected to the first treating apparatus **10** through the insulating connection member **450**.

(247) The insulating connection member **450** may be made of the insulating material. The insulating material may be selected as various materials according to need, such as a plastic material, a rubber material, a mixed material of the plastic and the rubber, or the like.

(248) The insulating connection member **450** may insulate the upper frame **400** and the first treating apparatus **10** from each other while fastening the upper frame **400** with the first side panel **115**. FIGS. **16** and **17** show a state in which the upper frame **400** is coupled to the first side panels **115** of the first treating apparatus **10** and is insulated from the first side panels **115** through the insulating connection members **450**, according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(249) The insulating connection member **450** may be formed in various shapes, and may fasten the

first treating apparatus **10** with the upper frame **400** in various fastening schemes. For example, the insulating connection member **450** may have the various fastening schemes, such as being formed in a hook shape, including a coupling member inserted therein, or being adhered to one face of the upper frame **400**.

(250) Referring to FIG. **10**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, in the upper frame **400**, lower portions of both side portions in the left and right direction Y may be respectively coupled to the second side panels **125**, and upper portions of the both side portions may be respectively coupled to the first side panels **115** through the insulating connection members **450**.

(251) The upper frame **400** may have a face parallel to the front face **133** of the second front panel **122**, and may extend in the left and right direction Y, so that at least portions of the both side portions in the left and right direction Y may be arranged in front of the second side panels **125**.

(252) The lower portions of the both side portions of the upper frame **400** may be respectively coupled to the second side panels **125**, and the upper portions of the both side portions may be respectively coupled to the first side panels **115**. That is, the both sides in the left and right direction Y of the upper frame **400** may be coupled together to the first front panel **112** of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second front panel **122** of the second treating apparatus **20**.

(253) FIG. **11** shows a perspective view of the insulating connection member **450**, and FIG. **12** is a cross-sectional view showing the coupling structure of each first side panel **115**, the insulating connection member **450**, and the upper frame **400**.

(254) Referring to FIGS. **11** to **12**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, each insulating connection member **450** may include a first fastening hole **460** and a second fastening hole **470** defined therein. The first fastening hole **460** may be coupled to the first side panel **115**, the second fastening hole **470** may be coupled to the upper frame **400**, and the second fastening hole **470** may insulate the upper frame **400** and the first side panel **115** from each other.

(255) Specifically, the insulating connection member **450** may have the first fastening hole **460** and the second fastening hole **470** connected to each other. The insulating connection member **450** may be fixed to the first side panel **115** as the first fastening hole **460** is coupled to the first side panel **115**.

(256) The upper frame **400** is fixed to the insulating connection members **450**, and the insulating connection members **450** are respectively fixed to the first side panels **115**, thereby the fixing structure or the coupling structure between the upper frame **400** and the first side panel **115** may be formed.

(257) The coupling scheme between the first fastening hole **460** and the first side panel **115** and the coupling scheme between the second fastening hole **470** and the upper frame **400** may be variously determined as needed. For example, a fitting coupling, a hook coupling, or the like may be used, or the coupling relationship may be formed through a fastening member penetrating the insulating connection member **450** as shown in FIGS. **11** and **12**.

(258) The upper frame **400** is coupled to the first side panels **115** through the insulating connection members **450** made of the insulating material, so that the insulation between the upper frame **400** and the first side panels **115** may be achieved by the insulating connection members **450**.

(259) For example, as shown in FIG. **19**, the second fastening hole **470** of the upper frame **400** may be positioned between the upper frame **400** and the first side panel **115** to prevent direct contact between the upper frame **400** and the first side panel **115**, thereby insulating the upper frame **400** and the first side panel **115** from each other.

(260) In one example, the first fastening hole **460** may extend upward from the second fastening hole **470** coupled with the upper frame **400**, and the upper frame **400** coupled to the second fastening hole **470** may be fastened to the first side panel **115** through the first fastening hole **460**.

(261) The both side portions of the upper frame **400** extending upward from the second treating apparatus **20** are respectively coupled to the second fastening holes **470**, and the first fastening holes **460** are respectively coupled to the first side panels **115** while being respectively coupled to

the second fastening holes **470**, so that the first fastening hole **460** may be located above the second fastening hole **470**.

(262) That is, the first fastening hole **460** located at an upper portion of each insulating connection member **450** may be coupled to each first side panel **115**, and the second fastening hole **470** located at a lower portion of each insulating connection member **450** may be coupled to the upper frame **400** while facing each side portion of the upper frame **400**.

(263) In other words, the first fastening hole **460** may be defined extending upward from the second fastening hole **470**, and the second fastening hole **470** may be defined extending downward from the first fastening hole **460**.

(264) In one example, as shown in FIG. **11**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, a fastening member forming a coupling structure of each insulating connection member **450** may be included, and the fastening member may include a first fastening member **462** and a second fastening member **472**.

(265) The first fastening member **462** may penetrate the first fastening hole **460** and the first side panel **115** together to fasten the first fastening hole **460** with the first side panel **115**, and the second fastening member **472** may penetrate the upper frame **400** and be inserted into the second fastening hole **470** to fasten the upper frame **400** with the second fastening hole **470**.

(266) That is, each upper end fastening portion **124** of the first front panel **112** and the upper frame **400** described above may be coupled to each insulating connection member **450** or each first side panel **115** by the fastening member, that is, the second fastening member **472**. The second fastening hole **470** may insulate the second fastening member **472** and the first side panel **115** from each other.

(267) Specifically, each insulating connection member **450** may be coupled to each first side panel **115** and the upper frame **400** through each first fastening member **462** and each second fastening member **472**. The first fastening member **462** may be formed in a shape of a screw, a rivet, or the like, and may penetrate the first fastening hole **460** and the first side panel **115** together.

(268) Because the first fastening member **462** is not directly in contact with the upper frame **400**, the first fastening hole **460** does not need to insulate the first fastening member **462** and the first side panel **115** from each other.

(269) In one example, the upper frame **400** may be penetrated by the second fastening member **472**, and the second fastening member **472** penetrated the upper frame **400** may be coupled to the second fastening hole **470** of the insulating connection member **450**. In this connection, the second fastening hole **470** may be defined to insulate the second fastening member **472** and the first side panel **115** from each other.

(270) The second fastening member **472** that may penetrate the upper frame **400** and may be in contact with and electrically connected to the upper frame **400** needs to be electrically insulated from the first side panel **115**. Accordingly, the insulating connection member **450** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may be constructed such that the second fastening hole **470** insulates the second fastening member **472** and the first side panel **115** from each other.

(271) There may be various schemes of insulating, by the second fastening hole **470**, the second fastening member **472** and the first side panel **115** from each other. For example, the second fastening hole **470** may be disposed in front of the first side panel **115**, and the second fastening member **472** may be inserted into and coupled to only the second fastening hole **470** excluding the first side panel **115** in the state of penetrating the upper frame **400**, so that the second fastening member **472** may be insulated from the first side panel **115**.

(272) Alternatively, as shown in FIGS. **11** to **12**, the second fastening hole **470** may be defined to surround the second fastening member **472** to insulate the first side panel **115** and the second fastening member **472** from each other.

(273) In one example, as shown in FIGS. **11** to **12**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the second fastening hole **470** may include a fastening insulating portion **474**. The fastening insulating

portion **474** may extend to penetrate the first side panel **115**, at least a portion of the second fastening member **472** may be inserted into the fastening insulating portion **474**, and the fastening insulating portion **474** may insulate the second fastening member **472** and the first side panel **115** from each other.

(274) The fastening insulating portion **474** may be formed in a hollow shape, and may extend along an insertion direction of the second fastening member **472** to penetrate the first side panel **115**. That is, the second fastening member **472** may be constructed to penetrate the upper frame **400** and the first side panel **115** together, but a portion of the second fastening member **472** penetrating the first side panel **115** may be surrounded by the fastening insulating portion **474**.

(275) The second fastening member **472** penetrated the upper frame **400** may penetrate the second fastening hole **470** and may be inserted into and coupled to the fastening insulating portion **474**. The second fastening member **472** may penetrate the upper frame **400** or the first side panel **115** in the longitudinal direction like the screw or the rivet.

(276) The second fastening member **472** may be coupled to the second fastening hole **470** while having a length of penetrating the first side panel **115** together with the upper frame **400** by the fastening insulating portion **474**, so that the coupling force may be improved. Because the second fastening member **472** is eventually inserted into and coupled to the fastening insulating portion **474** of the second fastening hole **470**, the insulation between the first side panel **115** and the second fastening member **472** may be achieved. Accordingly, the upper frame **400** that may be electrically connected to the second fastening member **472** may be insulated from the first side panel **115**.

(277) The fastening insulating portion **474** may be formed in a shape in which an extended end thereof is sealed to receive the second fastening member **472** in the fastening insulating portion **474**, or in a shape in which the extended end is opened and an end of the second fastening member **472** is exposed to the outside of the fastening insulating portion **474**.

(278) The fastening insulating portion **474** may be constructed to surround at least a portion of the second fastening member **472** that is positioned parallel to the first side panel **115** to receive at least a portion of the second fastening member **472** therein, and may insulate the first side panel **115** and the second fastening member **472** from each other. The first fastening member **462** and the second fastening member **472** may be separated apart from each other to be electrically separated from each other.

(279) In one example, the fastening insulating portion **474** may be constructed to penetrate the front end bent portion **116** of the first side panel **115**. The front end bent portion **116** may have a face parallel to the first front panel **112**, and the first fastening member **462** and the second fastening hole **470** may have lengths in the front and rear direction X and may penetrate the front end bent portion **116** along the front and rear direction X.

(280) The insulating connection member **450** and the upper frame **400** may be located in front of the front end bent portion **116** of the first side panel **115**, and the fastening insulating portion **474** may extend rearwardly from the second fastening hole **470** to penetrate the front end bent portion **116**.

(281) That is, as shown in FIG. 12, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the upper end fastening portion **124**, the upper frame **400**, the insulating connection member **450**, and the front end bent portion **116** are stacked in order, and the fastening member, that is, the second fastening member **472** may penetrate the stacked components from the upper end fastening portion **124** to the front end bent portion **116**, and fix the upper end fastening portion **124**.

(282) In the insulating connection member **450**, at least the portion of the second fastening member **472** may be inserted into the fastening insulating portion **474** of the second fastening hole **470** and may be coupled to the second fastening hole **470**. The second fastening hole **470** has the fastening insulating portion **474** penetrating the second side panel **125**, so that the coupling force between the insulating connection member **450** and the first side panel **115** may be strengthened, and the coupling force between the second fastening member **472** and the second fastening hole **470** may

also be strengthened, thereby improving the structural stability.

(283) In one example, as shown in FIGS. **8** and **9**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the upper end fastening portion **124** of the second front panel **122** may be penetrated by the second fastening member **472** together with the upper frame **400** to be fastened to the second fastening hole **470**.

(284) FIG. **12** shows a cross-section of the upper end fastening portion **124**, the upper frame **400**, the insulating connection member **450**, and the front end bent portion **116** of the first side panel **115** penetrated by the fastening member, that is, the second fastening member **472** to be coupled to each other in a state of being stacked with each other.

(285) The upper end fastening portion **124** may be overlapped with the upper frame **400** and the insulating connection member **450** in the front and rear direction X, and the second fastening member **472** may penetrate the upper end fastening portion **124** of the second front panel **122**, the upper frame **400**, the insulating connection member **450**, and the first side panel **115** in order and be coupled to the second fastening hole **470** of the insulating connection member **450**. In one example, the upper end fastening portion **124** may be electrically connected to the second fastening member **472** and the upper frame **400**.

(286) Because the second front panel **122** forms a coupling relationship with each first side panel **115** by the upper end fastening portion **124**, the fixing force of the second front panel **122** is improved, and at the same time, the fastening structure between the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** is also reinforced, which are advantageous.

(287) In one example, FIG. **13** shows the lower frame **300** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. **4** shows the lower frame **300** disposed at the lower front face of the first treating apparatus **10**, FIG. **8** shows the lower frame **300** coupled to the first treating apparatus **10** at a position above the upper end fastening portion **124**, and FIG. **9** shows the lower frame **300** of FIG. **8** separated from the first side panel **115** of the first treating apparatus **10**.

(288) Referring to FIGS. **4**, **13**, and the like, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, in the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first treating apparatus **10** may further include the lower frame **300**. The lower frame **300** may be coupled to the control panel **200** at the rear of the control panel **200** to fix the control panel **200**.

(289) The lower frame **300** may be constructed to be coupled to and fix the control panel **200** inserted between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**. The lower frame **300** may be disposed below the first front panel **112** and may be disposed at the rear of the control panel **200**.

(290) That is, the lower frame **300** may be located below the first front panel **112**, may be located in front of the first side panel **115**, and may be disposed at the rear of the control panel **200** and coupled to the control panel **200**.

(291) The lower frame **300** may be coupled with the control panel **200** while being fixed to the first treating apparatus **10**. There may be various schemes of coupling with the control panel **200**. For example, the side face **240** of the control panel **200** may be coupled with side end extensions **330** of the lower frame **300** to fix the control panel **200**.

(292) Referring to FIG. **4**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, both side faces in the left and right direction Y of the lower frame **300** may be respectively coupled to the first side panels **115** respectively facing toward the both side faces of the lower frame **300**.

(293) The both side faces in the left and right direction Y of the lower frame **300** may be respectively coupled to the first side panels **115**. The lower frame **300** may be disposed at the lower portion of the front face of the first treating apparatus **10**, and the both side faces in the left and right direction Y thereof may respectively face toward the first side panels **115** at the rear of the first side panels **115**.

(294) The lower frame **300** may be coupled to the front end bent portions **116** of the first side panels **115**. As for a coupling scheme, various schemes such as screw coupling, rivet coupling,

fitting coupling, and the like may be used.

(295) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the lower frame **300** has the both side faces in the left and right direction Y respectively coupled to the first side panels **115**, and the control panel **200** disposed at the front is coupled to the lower frame **300**, so that the control panel **200** that may be connected with the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122** may have the stable fixing structure.

(296) In one example, referring to FIG. **13**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the lower frame **300** may include a main frame face **310**. The main frame face **310** extends along the left and right direction Y of the first treating apparatus **10** and may divide an interior of the first treating apparatus **10** from the control panel **200**.

(297) Specifically, the main frame face **310** of the lower frame **300** may be disposed in parallel with the front face **210** of the control panel **200**. The main frame face **310** may extend in left and right direction Y, so that both ends thereof may be respectively coupled to the first side panels **115**.

(298) The main frame face **310** may be disposed between the interior of the first treating apparatus **10** and an interior of the control panel **200** to divide the interior of the first treating apparatus **10** from the interior of the control panel **200**. Inside the first treating apparatus **10**, various internals may be arranged, and there may be a large amount of water or a high-temperature air current as needed. In a process of using the first treating apparatus **10**, unintended leak may occur, or the air current may affect the process.

(299) Accordingly, an embodiment of the present disclosure may minimize influence of the water or a temperature change inside the first treating apparatus **10** on the control panel **200** as the lower frame **300** includes the main frame face **310** that divides the control panel **200** from the interior of the first treating apparatus **10**.

(300) The main frame face **310** may have various shapes as needed, and as described later, may include a convex portion **316** to secure a space in which the internals of the first treating apparatus **10** are arranged and effectively divide the control panel **200** from the interior of the first treating apparatus **10**.

(301) In one example, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, a connection hole **312** through which a signal connection line **314** for signally connecting the first treating apparatus **10** with the control panel **200** passes may be defined in the main frame face **310**.

(302) The above-described electric parts **224** may be arranged inside the control panel **200**, and the electric parts **224** may be connected to a sensor, a motor, the controller of first treating apparatus **10**, or the like disposed inside the first treating apparatus **10**.

(303) To this end, the signal connection line **314** may extend from the interior of the first treating apparatus **10** to the electric parts **224** of the control panel **200**, and signal connection between components of the first treating apparatus **10** and the control panel **200** may be achieved by the signal connection line **314**.

(304) In one example, the control panel **200** may be fixed by the lower frame **300**, and the lower frame **300** may include the main frame face **310** that divides the control panel **200** from the interior of the first treating apparatus **10**, so that the connection hole **312** through which the signal connection line **314** may pass may be defined in the main frame face **310**.

(305) A signal connection line **314** may have various shapes. For example, the signal connection line **314** may include a connection jack or a connection port, and may be connected to the electric parts **224** through the connection hole **312**. FIG. **15** shows the lower frame **300** dividing the electric parts **224** and the interior of the first treating apparatus **10** from each other according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(306) There may also be various positions and shapes of the connection hole **312**. Referring to FIG. **13**, the connection hole **312** may be defined on one side in the left and right direction Y of the main frame face **310**, and may be defined on a lower side of said one side, so that the signal connection line **314** may be effectively connected to the electric parts **224**.

(307) In one example, FIG. 14 shows a side view of the lower frame **300** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. Referring to FIGS. **13** to **14**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the lower frame **300** may further include an upper end extension **320** and a top coupling portion **350**.

(308) The upper end extension **320** may extend forward from an upper end of the main frame face **310**, and the top coupling portion **350** may protrude upward from the upper end extension **320** and be coupled to the bottom of the first front panel **112**.

(309) The upper end extension **320** may extend forward from the upper end of the main frame face **310** and may be positioned below the first front panel **112**. The upper end extension **320** may extend along the left and right direction Y like the main frame face **310**, and may extend forward from the main frame face **310**.

(310) The top coupling portion **350** may be disposed on the upper end extension **320**. The top coupling portion **350** may protrude upward from the upper end extension **320** positioned below the first front panel **112** and may be coupled to the bottom of the first front panel **112**.

(311) There may be various numbers, positions, and shapes of the top coupling portion **350** or schemes of coupling with the first front panel **112** as needed. The top coupling portion **350** may include a panel inserted portion **353** inserted into the lower end bent portion **113**.

(312) The lower end bent portion **113** may be disposed in parallel with the upper end extension **320**, and the top coupling portion **350** may include a panel inserted portion **353** protruding toward the lower end bent portion **113** to penetrate the lower end bent portion **113**.

(313) The panel inserted portion **353** may penetrate the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112** and may be inserted into the bottom of the first front panel **112**. The top coupling portion **350** may be coupled to the first front panel **112** as the panel inserted portion **353** penetrates and is inserted into the lower end bent portion **113**.

(314) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the lower frame **300** is fixed by being coupled with each first side panel **115**, fixes the control panel **200** by being coupled to the control panel **200** at the front, is coupled to the first front panel **112** through the upper end extension **320**, and supports the first front panel **112**, thereby effectively improving structural stability of the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(315) In one example, FIG. 15 is a cross-sectional view showing a state in which the lower frame **300**, the control panel **200**, and the first front panel **112** are fastened to each other. Referring to FIGS. **14** to **15**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, at least a portion of the panel inserted portion **353** may extend in an inclined manner such that an upper end thereof is positioned forwardly of a lower end thereof.

(316) That is, the panel inserted portion **353** may be formed to be inclined forward upwardly. An inclined portion of the panel inserted portion **353** may be formed on an entirety of or only a portion of the panel inserted portion **353**.

(317) As the panel inserted portion **353** extends in the inclined manner, the upper end thereof is disposed close to the front face of the first treating apparatus **10**. Accordingly, the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112** is moved rearward, so that the panel inserted portion **353** may be easily inserted, and fixation of the first front panel **112** into which the panel inserted portion **353** may be strengthened.

(318) In one example, the top coupling portion **350** may further include an ascending extension **354**. The ascending extension **354** may extend from the upper end extension **320** toward the lower end bent portion **113**. In addition, the panel inserted portion **353** may be disposed at an upper end of the ascending extension **354** to penetrate the lower end bent portion **113**.

(319) The first front panel **112**, for example, the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112** and the upper end extension **320** may be spaced apart from each other. The top face **220** of the control panel **200** may be inserted between the upper end extension **320** and the first front panel **112**.

(320) The top coupling portion **350** may include the ascending extension **354** extending upward from the upper end extension **320**, and the panel inserted portion **353** extending from the ascending extension **354** may be inserted into the first front panel **112**.

(321) The top fastening portion **350** may include a first top fastening portion **351** and a second top fastening portion **352**. The ascending extension **354** may be included in the first top fastening portion **351**. That is, in the first top fastening portion **351**, the ascending extension **354** extending from the upper end extension **320** may extend to the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112**, and the panel inserted portion **353** may be disposed on the upper end of the ascending extension **354** and be inserted into the first front panel **112** through the lower end bent portion **113**.

(322) There may be various shapes or extension directions of the ascending extension **354**, and FIG. **14** shows the plate-shaped panel inserted portion **353** extending in an inclined manner forward from the upper end of the plate-shaped ascending extension **354** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(323) In one example, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the top coupling portion **350** may include a top support, and the panel inserted portion **353** may be disposed on the top support. For example, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the top coupling portion **350** may include a second top coupling portion **352**, the second top coupling portion **352** may include the top support, and the panel inserted portion **353** may be disposed on the top support.

(324) Specifically, the top support may be disposed on the upper end extension **320** and support the lower end bent portion **113**. That is, the top support may be constructed such that an upper end thereof is in contact with the lower end bent portion **113** and supports the lower end bent portion **113** upward.

(325) The top support may have a face for supporting the lower end bent portion **113** or may be formed in a protrusion shape to be in contact with the lower end bent portion **113**.

(326) When the top support is disposed on the top coupling portion **350**, for example, in a case of the second top coupling portion **352** including the top support, the panel inserted portion **353** may be disposed on the top support to penetrate the lower end bent portion **113**.

(327) That is, the second top coupling portion **352** may be disposed such that the top support is in contact with the lower end bent portion **113** on the upper end extension **320**, and the panel inserted portion **353** may be disposed to protrude upward from the top support in contact with the lower end bent portion **113** to penetrate the lower end bent portion **113**.

(328) As above, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the top coupling portion **350** is constructed to include the top support supporting the lower end bent portion **113**, so that the bottom of the first front panel **112** may be supported upward by the lower frame **300** and may be structurally stabilized.

(329) In one example, as shown in FIG. **14**, the top support may include a top support face **357** that is spaced upwardly from the upper end extension **320**, and is disposed to be in parallel with the lower end bent portion **113** and supports the lower end bent portion **113**, and the panel inserted portion **353** may extend from the top support face **357**.

(330) The top support face **357** may be disposed to be in parallel with the lower end bent portion **113**, and may be disposed to be in parallel with the upper end extension **320**. That is, the top support face **357** may be in a form offset upward from the upper end extension **320**.

(331) The top support face **357** may be preferably in a face-contact with a bottom face of the lower end bent portion **113** to support the first front panel **112**.

(332) In addition, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the top support may further include a top connection portion **358** connecting the top support face **357** and the upper end extension **320** with each other, and the panel inserted portion **353** may be disposed on a front end of the top support face **357** and at least partially extend in an inclined manner such that an upper end thereof is positioned forward of a lower end thereof.

(333) The top support face **357** may be formed in a plate shape and may be disposed in parallel

with the lower end bent portion **113**, and may have a connection relationship with the upper end extension **320** by the top connection portion **358**. That is, in the top support and the top support face **357** may be connected to the upper end extension **320** by the top connection portion **358**.

(334) In one example, in a case of the second top coupling portion **352** having the top support, the panel inserted portion **353** may extend upward from the front end, that is, a front edge, of the top support face **357**. Accordingly, the first front panel **112** may be supported on the top support face **357** while being moved rearward on the top of the lower frame **300**, and the panel inserted portion **353** may penetrate and be coupled to the lower end bent portion **113**.

(335) In addition, the top connection portion **358** may be formed at both side edges and a rear edge of the top support face **357** to stably fix the top support face **357** to the upper end extension **320**.

(336) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the top coupling portion **350** includes a first top coupling portion **351** having the ascending extension **354** and coupled to the first front panel **112**, and a second top coupling portion **352** that supports and fixes the first front panel **112**, so that a coupling strength and a support strength between the first front panel **112** and the lower frame **300** may be efficiently determined. The numbers and positions of the first top coupling portion **351** and the second top coupling portion **352** may be variously determined as needed.

(337) In one example, as shown in FIGS. **13** to **14**, in the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the lower frame **300** may include the side end extensions **330**, and the side end extensions **330** may respectively extend forward from both sides of the lower frame **300** to be coupled to the control panel **200**.

(338) As described above, the lower frame **300** has the main frame face **310** that divides the control panel **200** from the interior of the first treating apparatus **10**, and may include the upper end extension **320** to support and fix the bottom of the first front panel **112**.

(339) Furthermore, an embodiment of the present disclosure includes the side end extensions **330** respectively extending forward from both sides in the left and right direction Y of the main frame face **310**, so that the lower frame **300** may be coupled with the first front panel **112** upward, and at the same time, may be coupled with the control panel **200** in the front through the side end extensions **330**, thereby enabling efficient space utilization and realizing a coupling structure.

(340) The side end extension **330** may include a first side end extension **332** disposed on one side in the left and right direction Y of the lower frame **300** and a second side end extension **334** disposed on the other side in the left and right direction Y of the lower frame **300**.

(341) In addition, as shown in FIG. **13**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first side end extension **332** may include a hook inserting portion **336** into which a side face hook **246** disposed on the control panel **200** is inserted, and the second side end extension **334** may include a through hole **338** coupled with a penetrating member **248** penetrating the control panel **200**. FIG. **11** is a view of the first side end extension **332** including the hook inserting portion **336** viewed from the rear.

(342) The first side end extension **332** includes the hook inserting portion **336** into which the side face hook **246** disposed on the control panel **200** is inserted. The control panel **200** may include a first side face **242** on one side in the left and right direction Y, and may include the side face hook **246** disposed inside the first side face **242**.

(343) Specifically, the first side end extension **332** may be disposed on one side in the left and right direction Y of the main frame face **310** to face toward an inner face of the first side face **242**, and the side face hook **246** may be disposed between the first side face **242** and the first side end extension **332**.

(344) The side face hook **246** may protrude toward the first side end extension **332** and be inserted into the hook inserting portion **336** of the first side end extension **332**, so that the control panel **200** may be fixed to the lower frame **300**.

(345) The side face hook **246** may protrude from one side in the left and right direction Y of the control panel **200** toward the other side and may be inserted into the first side end extension **332** of

the lower frame **300**.

(346) In one example, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the control panel **200** may further include a hook extension **247**. The hook extension **247** may extend rearward from the front face **210**, may be located between the first side face **242** and the first side end extension **332**, may be spaced apart from the first side face **242**, and may have the side face hook **246** at an extended end thereof.

(347) The hook extension **247** may extend rearward from the rear face of the front face **210** of the control panel **200**, and may be spaced apart from the inner face of the first side face **242**, that is, one face of the first side face **242** facing toward the other side in the left and right direction Y of the control panel **200**.

(348) As the side face hook **246** and the hook extension **247** are arranged between the first side face **242** of the control panel **200** and the first side end extension **332** of the lower frame **300**, and as the side face hook **246** is disposed on an end of the hook extension **247** spaced apart from the first side face **242**, in an insertion process of the control panel **200**, the hook extension **247** may be bent and deformed as needed such that the side face hook **246** is inserted into the hook inserting portion **336**.

(349) For example, when the hook extension **247** is in close contact with the first side face **242** or when the side face hook **246** is disposed on the inner face of the first side face **242**, in the insertion process of the control panel **200**, the first side face **242** itself of the control panel **200** deforms in a process in which the side face hook **246** reaches the hook inserting portion **336** of the first side end extension **332**, resulting in inconvenience in the coupling or a damage.

(350) However, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, as the side face hook **246** is disposed on the hook extension **247** spaced apart from the first side face **242**, in the process of coupling the control panel **200** and the lower frame **300** with each other, the hook extension **247** is partially bent and the side face hook **246** is moved toward the hook inserting portion **336**, so that effective coupling may be achieved.

(351) In one example, the control panel **200** may have the second side face **244** disposed on the other side in the left and right direction Y, and the side end extension **330** may further include the second side end extension **334**. The second side end extension **334** may be disposed on the other side in the left and right direction Y of the main frame face **310** to face toward the inner face of the second side face **244**.

(352) The second side face **244** of the control panel **200** may be penetrated by the penetrating member **248**, and the second side end extension **334** of the lower frame **300** positioned on the inner face of the second side face **244** may include the through hole **338** into which the penetrating member **248** is coupled. FIG. 5 shows the penetrating member **248** that penetrates through the second side face **244** of the control panel **200** and is coupled to the through hole **338** defined in the second side end extension **334** of the lower frame **300**.

(353) The through hole **338** may be penetrated by the penetrating member **248** like the second side face **244**, or may be coupled to the penetrating member **248** as the penetrating member **248** penetrated the second side face **244** is inserted thereto. The penetrating member **248** may have various shapes such as a screw shape, a rivet shape, or the like.

(354) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first side end extension **332** of the lower frame **300** is coupled with the first side face **242** of the control panel **200** through the hook inserting portion **336**, and the second side end extension **334** of the lower frame **300** is coupled with the second side face **244** of the control panel **200** through the through hole **338**, so that assembly efficiency may be improved and a structure having excellent coupling stability may be implemented.

(355) For example, when both the first side end extension **332** and the second side end extension **334** of the lower frame **300** are coupled with the control panel **200** in a hook manner through the hook inserting portion **336**, compared to the coupling using the penetrating member **248**, the coupling stability may be lower, and it may be disadvantageous in separating the control panel **200**

when necessary.

(356) In addition, when both the first side end extension **332** and the second side end extension **334** of the lower frame **300** are coupled with the control panel **200** using the penetrating member **248**, there is no means for the control panel **200** to be fixed at an appropriate position to be coupled with the lower frame **300**, and a process and a component required for the assembly process are added, which may be disadvantageous.

(357) Accordingly, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first side face **242** of the control panel **200** and the first side end extension **332** of the lower frame **300** are coupled with each other through the side face hook **246** and the hook inserting portions **336**, so that the position of the control panel **200** at the beginning of the coupling of the control panel **200** may be effectively fixed.

(358) In addition, the second side face **244** of the control panel **200** and the second side end extension **334** of the lower frame **300** are coupled with each other through the penetrating member **248** and the through hole **338** in a penetrating manner, so that a stable coupling structure in which coupling and separation are easy may be maintained.

(359) Referring again to FIGS. **13** to **15**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the main frame face **310** of the lower frame **300** may include the convex portion **316** that is curved such that a front face of the convex portion **316** is convex and a rear face of the convex portion **316** is concave to define a space at the rear.

(360) The convex portion **316** may have a shape extending along the left and right direction Y of the lower frame **300** so as to be parallel with a longitudinal direction of the main frame face **310**. In addition, as the front face of the convex portion **316** is convex and the rear face thereof is concave, the space is secured at the rear, so that the convex portion **316** and the components inside the first treating apparatus **10** do not interfere with each other.

(361) FIG. **15** shows a state in which a base cabinet **15** of the first treating apparatus **10** is disposed at the rear of the main frame face **310** of the lower frame **300** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. **8** shows that the convex portion **316** of the main frame face **310** is bent so as to correspond to the base cabinet **15**, and thus, a space in which the base cabinet **15** is disposed is secured without interference between the base cabinet **15** and the lower frame **300** located at the rear. The base cabinet **15** may correspond to the first bottom panel of the first treating apparatus **10** or may be a component included in the first bottom panel.

(362) The convex portion **316** may be formed to include the top of the main frame face **310**, and the upper end extension **320** may extend from the convex portion **316**. That is, the convex portion **316** may have a shape in which the space defined at the rear is opened upward.

(363) The convex portion **316** may extend downward from the upper end of the main frame face **310** and may extend along the left and right direction Y. The connection hole **312** may be defined in the convex portion **316** or may be positioned avoiding the convex portion **316**.

(364) Because the lower frame **300** has the shape in which the convex portion **316** is formed on the top of the main frame face **310** and the space defined at the rear is opened upward, a space in which the base cabinet **15** and the like that may be positioned at the rear of the lower frame **300** may be effectively secured, and a support strength of the first front panel **112** supported by the upper end extension **320** may be effectively improved.

(365) In one example, as described above, the lower frame **300** may include the top coupling portion **350**, and in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the top face **220** of the control panel **200** may have a coupling portion receiving groove **269** into which the top coupling portion **350** of the lower frame **300** is inserted and received.

(366) FIG. **5** shows the control panel **200**, wherein the control panel **200** is coupled with the lower frame **300**, so that the top coupling portion **350** is positioned within the coupling portion receiving groove **269**.

(367) Specifically, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the top face **220** of the control panel

200 may be inserted between the lower end bent portion **113** and the upper end extension **320**, and as described above, the upper end extension **320** may include the top coupling portion **350** protruding upward and inserted into the lower end bent portion **113**.

(368) In addition, the top face **220** may include the coupling portion receiving groove **269** that is opened rearward, and the top coupling portion **350** is inserted into the coupling portion receiving groove **269** from the rear.

(369) The coupling portion receiving groove **269** may have a shape extending in the front and rear direction X in consideration of an insertion direction of the control panel **200**, and a width of the coupling portion receiving groove **269** may be greater than that of the top coupling portion **350**. A rear end of the coupling portion receiving groove **269** may be disposed to face toward the top coupling portion **350** and opened rearward, so that the top coupling portion **350** may be inserted into the coupling portion receiving groove **269** through the open rear end of the coupling portion receiving groove **269**.

(370) That is, in the process in which the control panel **200** in front of the lower frame **300** is moved rearward and inserted, the top coupling portion **350** of the lower frame **300** may move forward from the rear of the coupling portion receiving groove **269** and be inserted into the coupling portion receiving groove **269**.

(371) Accordingly, the upper end extension **320** having the top coupling portion **350** coupled to the first front panel **112** and supporting the first front panel **112** is included in the lower frame **300**. In the structure in which the top face **220** of the control panel **200** is inserted between the upper end extension **320** and the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112**, the top coupling portion **350** protruding from the upper end extension **320** of the lower frame **300** toward the lower end bent portion **113** may be positioned without structural interference by the coupling portion receiving groove **269**. In addition, the top face **220** of the control panel **200** may also be inserted between the first front panel **112** and the upper end extension **320** of the lower frame **300** without interference by the top coupling portion **350**.

(372) In one example, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the control panel **200** may further include the electric parts **224** and the electric parts coupling portion **228**, and the upper end extension **320** of the lower frame **300** may include a front receiving groove **324** into which the electric parts coupling portion **228** is inserted and received.

(373) In one example, FIG. 6 shows the electric parts coupling portion **228** protruding inward from the top face of the control panel **200**, FIG. 7 shows the electric parts **224** inside the control panel **200** and the electric parts coupling portion **228** protruding downward from the inner face of the top face **220** of the control panel **200**, and FIG. 13 shows the lower frame **300** having the front receiving groove **324** defined therein.

(374) The electric parts coupling portion **228** may protrude downward from the inner face of the top face **220** and may be coupled to the electric parts **224** inside the control panel **200**. The electric parts coupling portion **228** may include a plurality of electric parts coupling portions. The electric parts coupling portion **228** may have a protrusion shape as shown in FIG. 6 and be inserted into and coupled to a groove defined in the electric parts **224**, or may be disposed to rearwardly support a rear face of the electric parts **224** as shown in FIG. 7.

(375) In one example, the upper end extension **320** of the lower frame **300** may be located below the top face **220** of the control panel **200**, and thus, in the insertion process of the control panel **200**, the electric parts coupling portion **228** may be in contact with a front end of the upper end extension **320** and interfere with the movement of the control panel **200**.

(376) Accordingly, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, as shown in FIG. 13, the front receiving groove **324** into which the electric parts coupling portion **228** is inserted and received may be defined at the front end of the upper end extension **320**.

(377) The front receiving groove **324** may be defined to face toward the electric parts coupling portion **228**. That is, the front receiving groove **324** may be located at the rear of the electric parts

coupling portion **228**. The front receiving groove **324** may extend in the front and rear direction X in consideration of the coupling direction of the control panel **200**, and a front end of the front receiving groove **324** may be opened forward.

(378) In the process in which the control panel **200** is inserted between the first front panel **112** and the second front panel **122**, the electric parts coupling portion **228** may be inserted into the front receiving groove **324** through the open front end of the front receiving groove **324**.

(379) In one example, as shown in FIGS. **6** to **7**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, a length of the top face **220** of the control panel **200** extending rearward from the front face **210** may be less than a length of the bottom face **230** extending rearward from the front face **210**, so that the interference with the upper end extension **320** of the lower frame **300** may be prevented.

(380) As described above, the top face **220** of the control panel **200** may be disposed adjacent to the upper end extension **320** of the lower frame **300** in the vertical direction Z. The upper end extension **320** of the lower frame **300** has the top coupling portion **350** coupled to the first front panel **112**, and the top face **220** of the control panel **200** may have the electric parts coupling portion **228**.

(381) As such, the upper end extension **320** of the lower frame **300** and the top face **220** of the control panel **200** may respectively have components for the coupling and the support in a relationship therebetween or in a relationship with the first front panel **112**, which may cause the structural interference therebetween.

(382) In consideration of the above structural features, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the top face **220** of the control panel **200** is formed to have a smaller length than the bottom face **230**, so that the structural interference between the upper end extension **320** of the lower frame **300** and the top face **220** of the control panel **200** may be prevented, and structural degrees of freedom therebetween may be effectively improved.

(383) In one example, as described above, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the top face fastening elastic portion **266** may be disposed on the top face **220** of the control panel **200**, and the bottom face fastening elastic portion **267** may be disposed on the bottom face **230** of the control panel **200**.

(384) In addition, referring to FIG. **6**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the top face fastening elastic portion **266** may be disposed to intersect the top face opening **263** along the left and right direction Y of the control panel **200**, and the bottom face fastening elastic portion **267** may be disposed to intersect the bottom face opening **264** along the front and rear direction X of the control panel **200**.

(385) That is, the top face fastening elastic portion **266** may extend along the left and right direction Y of the control panel **200**, and the bottom face fastening elastic portion **267** may extend along the front and rear direction X of the control panel **200**. The top face opening **263** may also extend in the left and right direction Y like the top face fastening elastic portion **266**, and the bottom face opening **264** may also extend in the front and rear direction X like the bottom face fastening elastic portion **267**.

(386) As described above, at least a portion of the upper end extension **320** of the lower frame **300** overlaps the top face **220** of the control panel **200** and has a coupling relationship with the first front panel **112** and the like, so that the top face **220** of the control panel **200** may have a length of extending from the front face **210** that is smaller than that of the bottom face **230** to minimize the structural interference with the upper end extension **320**.

(387) Accordingly, the top face fastening elastic portion **266** disposed on the top face **220** has a disadvantage in extending in the front and rear direction X because of the small length of the top face **220**. Accordingly, the top face fastening elastic portion **266** may extend in the left and right direction Y of the control panel **200**. The top face opening **263** may also extend in the left and right direction Y like the top face fastening elastic portion **266**.

(388) In addition, because of the characteristics of the bottom face **230** having the larger extension

length compared to the top face **220**, the bottom face fastening elastic portion **267** disposed on the bottom face **230** may extend in the front and rear direction X unlike the top face fastening elastic portion **266**, and the bottom face opening **264** may also extend in the front and rear direction X like the bottom face fastening elastic portion **267**. The panel fastening portion **260** may protrude upward from the top face fastening elastic portion **266** and may protrude downward from the bottom face fastening elastic portion.

(389) In one example, referring to FIG. 5 again, the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may have a drain passage **270** extending in the left and right direction Y on the top face **220** of the control panel **200**.

(390) The drain passage **270** may extend along the left and right direction Y on the top face **220**, and water falling to the top face **220** may be drained by flowing in the left and right direction Y along the drain passage **270**.

(391) Specifically, as described above, the water may exist inside the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20**, such as a washing machine or a condensing dryer, and the water may leak or may be generated in other operating situations of the first treating apparatus **10**.

(392) The water may fall along the first treating apparatus **10** or may be supplied to the control panel **200** in other schemes. As described above, the control panel **200** may have the display and the manipulation unit on the front face thereof, and may have the electric parts **224** therein.

Therefore, it is necessary to prevent the water existing on the control panel **200** from flowing into the control panel **200** or flowing along the front face **210**.

(393) Accordingly, an embodiment of the present disclosure may form the drain passage **270** on the top face **220** of the control panel **200**, and the inflow of the water supplied to the top face **220** of the control panel **200** to the front face **210** or the interior of the control panel **200** may be minimized through the drain passage **270**.

(394) In addition, because the control panel **200** is located below the first front panel **112**, in consideration of the situation in which the water flowing downward along the first front panel **112** falls to the top face **220** of the control panel **200**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the drain passage **270** may be formed on the top face **220** of the control panel **200**.

(395) The drain passage **270** may be formed in various shapes, and may be formed in various schemes as necessary. FIG. 12 shows a state in which the drain passage **270** opened upward is disposed on the top face **220** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(396) The drain passage **270** may extend along the left and right direction Y of the control panel **200**. Accordingly, the water falling to the top face **220** may flow in the left and right direction Y on the top face **220**, and a phenomenon in which the water passes the rear end of the top face **220** and flows into the control panel **200** or flows along the front face **210** of the control panel **200** may be suppressed.

(397) In one example, referring to FIG. 5, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the drain passage **270** may be formed by the upper end of the front face **210** and the passage rib.

(398) Specifically, the top face **220** of the control panel **200** may extend rearward from the upper end of the front face **210**, and the upper end of the front face **210** may be positioned higher than the top face **220**. That is, the top face **220** may extend rearward from the front face **210** at a vertical level lower than that of the upper end of the front face **210**. In other words, the front face **210** may extend upward such that the upper end is positioned higher than the top face **220**.

(399) In addition, the passage rib protruding upward and extending along the left and right direction Y may be disposed at the rear end of the top face **220**. The top face **220** may extend in the left and right direction Y of the control panel **200** like the front face **210**, and the passage rib may also extend in the left and right direction Y along the top face **220**.

(400) In addition, as described above, the top face **220** may have the coupling portion receiving groove **269** defined therein that is opened rearward at the rear end thereof. A specific extending shape of the passage rib may correspond to a shape of the rear end of the top face **220**. That is, the

passage rib may extend along the rear end of the top face **220**.

(401) The drain passage **270** may be formed on the top face **220** by the upper end and the passage rib of the front face **210**.

(402) That is, the upper end of the front face **210** may form one side wall of the drain passage **270**, the passage rib may form an opposite side wall to said one side wall of the drain passage **270**, and the top face of the top face **220** may form a bottom face of the drain passage **270** to form the drain passage **270**.

(403) In an embodiment of the present disclosure as above, the drain passage **270** may be formed on an entirety of the top face of the top face **220**. Accordingly, the water falling to or flowing to the top face **220** may be entirely located in the drain passage **270**, or may be drained by flowing in the left and right direction Y along the drain passage **270**.

(404) In one example, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, an upper end of each side face **240** of the control panel **200** may be located above the top face **220**, and both ends of the passage rib in the left and right direction Y may be respectively spaced apart from the side faces **240** respectively facing thereto, so that each drainage may be defined between the upper end of each side face **240** and the passage rib.

(405) Specifically, each side face **240** extending rearward from each of both sides in the left and right direction Y of the front face **210** has the upper end positioned higher than the top face **220** like the front face **210**. The upper end of the front face **210** and the upper end of the side face **240** may extend integrally. Accordingly, the top face **220** may be disposed such that the front end and both side ends thereof are surrounded by the upper end of the front face **210** and the upper end of the side face **240**.

(406) Both side ends of the passage rib in the left and right direction Y may be respectively spaced apart from the upper ends of the side faces **240** respectively facing thereto. That is, in the drain passage **270**, an opening may be defined between each side end of the passage rib and the upper end of each side face **240** to define the drainage. The water present on the top face **220** may be discharged from the top face **220** through the drainage **276**.

(407) In one example, both sides in the left and right direction Y of the electric parts **224** that may be arranged inside the control panel **200** may be respectively spaced apart from the inner faces of the side faces **240** by a predetermined distance so as to be prevented from contacting the water discharged through the drainage.

(408) As above, by the drain passage **270** defined by the upper end of the front face **210** and the upper ends of the side faces **240**, the water falling on the top face **220** may be prevented from leaking to the outside along the front face **210** or the side faces **240**, and may be discharged rearward from the both sides in the left and right direction Y of the control panel **200** through the drainages respectively defined between the passage rib and the side faces **240**.

(409) In addition, as shown in FIG. 5, the panel support **268** and the panel fastening portion **260** arranged on the top face **220** of the control panel **200** may be located in the drain passage **270**. As described above, the panel support **268** may be disposed on the drain passage **270** to support the lower end bent portion **113** of the first front panel **112**, and the panel fastening portion **260** may be disposed on the drain passage **270** and penetrate the lower end bent portion **113**.

(410) The panel support **268** and the panel fastening portion **260** may respectively include a plurality of panel supports and a plurality of panel fastening portions, may be arranged in left and right direction Y along the drain passage **270**, and may be arranged to alternate with each other. Accordingly, a supporting force of the first front panel **112** by the panel support **268** and a fixing force of the first front panel **112** by the panel fastening portion **260** may be properly mixed and dispersed.

(411) In one example, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the top face **220** may further include an inflow prevention rib **274**. The inflow prevention rib **274** may extend to surround the opening **262** defined in the top face **220** and protrude upward to prevent the water from flowing

into the opening **262**. The opening **262** may be the top face opening **263** on which the top face fastening elastic portion **266** is disposed.

(412) The panel fastening portion **260** may be disposed in the drain passage **270** and may be disposed on the fastening elastic portion **265** disposed with the opening **262**. That is, the opening **262** on which the fastening elastic portion **265** is formed may be defined in the drain passage **270**, and the water on the top face **220** may fall into the control panel **200** through the opening **262**.

(413) Accordingly, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the inflow prevention rib **274** surrounding the opening **262** may be formed on the top face **220** to prevent the water leakage through the opening **262**.

(414) The inflow prevention rib **274** may extend in a ring shape to surround a circumference of the opening **262**. The ring shape may be various depending on the shape of the opening **262**, and may have, for example, a polygonal or circular cross-section.

(415) As a result, while being prevented from flowing into the opening **262** by the inflow prevention rib **274**, the water on the drain passage **270** defined by the upper end of the front face **210** and the passage rib may flow in the left and right direction Y along the drain passage **270** and be drained.

(416) In one example, as described above, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the coupling portion receiving groove **269** may be defined in the top face **220**. The passage rib extending along the rear end of the top face **220** may be extended so as to correspond to the coupling portion receiving groove **269**, so that the water leakage into the coupling portion receiving groove **269** may be prevented.

(417) In one example, FIG. **16** shows a view of the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure viewed from the rear, FIG. **17** shows a perspective view of the rear bracket **480**, and FIG. **18** shows the rear bracket **480** coupled to the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** viewed at the rear.

(418) As shown in FIGS. **16** and **18**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first treating apparatus **10** may have the first rear panel **118** disposed on the rear face thereof, and the second treating apparatus **20** may have the second rear panel **128** disposed on the rear face thereof. In addition, the rear bracket **480** made of an insulating material and fastening the first rear panel **118** and the second rear panel **128** with each other may be further included.

(419) As described above, the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** may be electrically insulated from each other and coupled to each other by the insulating connection member **450** and the upper frame **400** at the front side.

(420) Further, the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** may be electrically insulated from each other and be coupled to each other through the rear bracket **480** at the rear side.

(421) The first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** are manufactured separately from each other, and then stacked together and installed to be used together. Therefore, in order to secure the structural stability of the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, structural fastening between the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** stacked together may be required.

(422) Further, as described above, the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** respectively include electricity consuming devices independent of each other, such as the components like the motors, the controllers, or the like, so that it may be advantageous that the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** are electrically insulated from each other.

(423) Accordingly, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** may be fastened to each other through the upper frame **400** and the insulating connection member **450** at the front face of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20** stacked together, and may be fastened to each other through the rear bracket

480 at the rear side.

(424) The rear bracket **480** may be made of the insulating material. For example, the rear bracket **480** may be made of the insulating material, such as a plastic material, a rubber material, or a synthetic material of the plastic and the rubber.

(425) The rear bracket **480** may have a length parallel to the left and right direction Y, and may have a length corresponding to a width in the left and right direction Y of the first treating apparatus **10** or the second treating apparatus **20**. The rear bracket **480** may be coupled with the first rear panel **118** of the first treating apparatus **10** and the second rear panel **128** of the second treating apparatus **20** together to fasten the first rear panel **118** and the second rear panel **128** with each other.

(426) There may be various coupling schemes between the rear bracket **480**, the first rear panel **118**, and the second rear panel **128**. For example, the rear bracket **480** may be coupled to the first rear panel **118** and the second rear panel **128** together through screws, rivets, or the like, or the hook coupling or the fitting coupling scheme may be used.

(427) In one example, referring to FIG. **18**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the rear bracket **480** may be coupled to the first rear panel **118** and the second rear panel **128** to support the first rear panel **118** forward.

(428) The rear bracket **480** may fasten the first rear panel **118** and the second rear panel **128** with each other as an upper portion of the rear bracket **480** is coupled to the first rear panel **118** and a lower portion of the rear bracket **480** is coupled to the second rear panel **128**.

(429) In this connection, a front face **481** facing forward of the rear bracket **480** may have an upper end **482** in contact with the first rear panel **118**, and a lower end **483** in contact with the second rear panel **128**. That is, in the rear bracket **480**, the upper end **482** of the front face **481** may support the first rear panel **118** from the rear, and the lower end **483** of the front face **481** may support the second rear panel **128** from the rear.

(430) Accordingly, in a state of being disposed on the second treating apparatus **20**, the first treating apparatus **10** may be supported rearward by the upper end of the second front panel **122** at the front, and may be supported forward by the rear bracket **480** at the rear, so that the position of the first treating apparatus **10** may be fixed in the front and rear direction X.

(431) In one example, as shown in FIG. **18**, in an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first rear panel **118** may be located forward of the second rear panel **128**, and the front face **481** of the rear bracket **480** may be formed in a stepped manner such that the upper end **482** supporting the first rear panel **118** is located forward of the lower end **483** supporting the second rear panel **128**.

(432) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the first rear panel **118** and the second rear panel **128** may be arranged to be spaced apart from each other in the front and rear direction X. For example, the first rear panel **118** may be located forward or rearward of the second rear panel **128**. A positional relationship of the first rear panel **118** to the second rear panel **128** may be determined from a design difference between the first treating apparatus **10** and the second treating apparatus **20**.

(433) For example, when a length in the front and rear direction X of the first treating apparatus **10** is larger than that of the second treating apparatus **20**, the first rear panel **118** may be located rearward of the second rear panel **128**. When the length in the front and rear direction X of the first treating apparatus **10** is smaller than that of the second treating apparatus **20**, the first rear panel **118** may be located forward of the second rear panel **128**.

(434) Alternatively, for an assembly advantage for stacking the first treating apparatus **10** on the second treating apparatus **20**, the first rear panel **118** may be positioned in front of the second rear panel **128**. For example, in the process of assembling the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, when the second treating apparatus **20** is disposed in an installation region and then the first treating apparatus **10** is lifted on the second treating apparatus **20**, the first treating apparatus **10** may slide rearward from a position in front of the second treating

apparatus **20** and may be disposed on the second treating apparatus **20**.

(435) In this process, the rear bracket **480** may be installed in advance on the second rear panel **128** of the second treating apparatus **20**, and the first treating apparatus **10** may be disposed at an appropriate assembly position while a distance of sliding rearward is limited by the rear bracket **480**.

(436) In an embodiment of the present disclosure, the length in the front and rear direction X of the first treating apparatus **10** may be smaller than that of the second treating apparatus **20**, or at least the lower portion of the first rear panel **118** may be located forward of the second rear panel **128** such that a stopper role of the rear bracket **480** may be achieved.

(437) The front face **481** of the rear bracket **480** may have the stepped shape as shown in FIG. **18** such that the upper end **482** of the front face **481** that forwardly supports the lower portion of the first rear panel **118** is located forward of the lower end **483** that forwardly supports the upper portion of the second rear panel **128**.

(438) When the lower portion of the first rear panel **118** is located rearward of the second rear panel **128**, the front face **481** of the rear bracket **480** may have the stepped shape such that the upper end **482** is positioned rearward of the lower end **483**.

(439) As the front face **481** of the rear bracket **480** has the stepped shape as above, the rear bracket **480** may be coupled to the first rear panel **118** and the second rear panel **128** and fasten the first rear panel **118** and the second rear panel **128** with each other while allowing a positional difference between the first rear panel **118** and the second rear panel **128**, and a support structure for supporting the first rear panel **118** of the first treating apparatus **10** located on the second treating apparatus **20** from the rear may be stably realized.

(440) In one example, referring to FIG. **17**, the laundry treating apparatus **1** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may have a handle **485** on the rear bracket **480**. Specifically, the handle **485** opened downward may be disposed on the lower portion of the rear bracket **480**.

(441) The handle **485** may have a shape of a groove that is open downward and recessed upward. The groove of the handle **485** may be defined such that the user may easily grip the handle **485** by putting a finger into the groove.

(442) There may be various positions and shapes of the handle **485**, and FIGS. **17** and **18** show the handle **485** that forms a portion of the lower portion of the rear bracket **480** and is opened downward to be gripped by the user, according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(443) Although the present disclosure has been illustrated and described in relation to a specific embodiment, it is understood that the present disclosure may be variously improved and changed within the scope of the technical idea of the present disclosure provided by the following claims. It will be obvious to those of ordinary skill in the industry.

Claims

1. A laundry treating apparatus comprising: a dryer including: a first cabinet that includes a first side panel, a first drum disposed in the first cabinet, a first motor configured to rotate the first drum, and a first front panel that (i) extends vertically, (ii) has a first laundry opening that is in fluid communication with the first drum, and (iii) is coupled to a front of the first cabinet; a washing machine including: a second cabinet that includes a second side panel, a second drum disposed in the second cabinet, a second motor configured to rotate the second drum, and a second front panel that extends vertically and defines a second laundry opening in fluid communication with the second drum, the second front panel being coupled to the second side panel and extending above an upper end of the second side panel; and a control panel that is operationally connected with the dryer and the washing machine and that includes an input unit configured to receive operational commands for the washing machine, wherein the dryer is configured to be stacked on the washing machine, wherein the second front panel is configured to be coupled to the first side panel and

support a front side of the dryer based on the dryer being stacked on the washing machine, and wherein the control panel is configured to be inserted between the first front panel and the second front panel in a state in which the second front panel is coupled to the first side panel.

2. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the second front panel includes: a front surface that defines the second laundry opening; an upper end bent portion extending rearward from an upper end of the front surface; and an upper end fastening portion extending upward from the upper end bent portion and coupled to the first side panel.

3. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 2, wherein an upper part of the second front panel protrudes upward beyond a top of the washing machine, and wherein, based on the second front panel being coupled to the second side panel, the dryer is stacked on top of the washing machine, and the upper part of the second front panel overlaps with a lower part of the first side panel in a front-rear direction.

4. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 3, wherein the second front panel further includes a first side end bent portion and a second side end bent portion that extend rearward from a first side edge and a second side edge of the front surface, respectively, and wherein the upper end fastening portion extends upward from a rear end of the upper end bent portion.

5. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 4, wherein the upper end bent portion is positioned above the upper end of the second side panel.

6. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 2, wherein the first side panel includes a front end bent portion extending inward from a front end of the front end bent portion, and wherein the upper end fastening portion is coupled to the front end bent portion.

7. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 4, wherein the washing machine further includes an upper frame disposed between the second front panel and the second side panel and coupled to the second side panel, and wherein the upper frame extends above the upper end of the second side panel and is coupled to the first side panel together with the second front panel.

8. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 7, wherein the upper frame extends in a left-right direction, wherein a first end of the upper frame is coupled to the first side end bent portion and a second end of the upper frame is coupled to the second side end bent portion, and wherein an upper part of the upper frame is coupled to the first side panel together with the upper end fastening portion.

9. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 8, wherein the dryer further includes an insulating connection member coupled to the first side panel, and wherein the upper end fastening portion and the upper frame are coupled to the insulating connection member.

10. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 9, wherein the insulating connection member includes: a fastening insulation portion inserted into the first side panel; a first fastening member extending upward along the front surface of the first side panel from the fastening insulation portion; and a second fastening member extending downward along the front surface of the first side panel from the fastening insulation portion and disposed between the upper frame and the first side panel.

11. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 10, wherein a lower end of the first front panel is positioned above a lower end of the first side panel, wherein the dryer further includes a lower frame that is coupled to the first side panel below the first front panel to cover a front lower portion of the first cabinet, and wherein the lower frame is spaced apart from the upper frame.

12. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 11, wherein the control panel is disposed in front of the lower frame, and wherein the lower frame has a shape protruding convexly forward.

13. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 12, wherein the control panel is inserted and coupled between the first front panel and the second front panel from front to back.

14. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 13, wherein an upper portion of the control panel is coupled to a lower portion of the first front panel, and a lower portion of the control panel is coupled to an upper portion of the second front panel.

15. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 1, wherein a front surface of the control panel is disposed on a same vertical plane as the first front panel and the second front panel.
16. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 14, wherein the first front panel includes a lower end bent portion extending rearward from a lower end of the front surface, and wherein the control panel includes: an upper surface facing the lower end bent portion; a lower surface facing the upper end bent portion; a first panel fastening portion protruding upward from the upper surface; and a second panel fastening portion protruding downward from the lower surface, wherein the upper end bent portion includes a first opening accommodating the first panel fastening portion, wherein the lower end bent portion includes a second opening accommodating the second panel fastening portion, and wherein the control panel is inserted rearward such that the first and second panel fastening portions are coupled to the first and second openings.
17. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 10, wherein the upper frame is coupled to and contacts the second side panel, wherein the upper frame is coupled to the second side panel while being spaced apart from the second side panel by the insulating connection member.
18. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the washing machine further includes an upper frame that is disposed between the second front panel and the second side panel and that is coupled to the second side panel, and wherein the upper frame extends above the upper end of the second side panel and is coupled to the first side panel together with the second front panel.
19. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 18, wherein the dryer further includes an insulating connection member coupled to the first side panel, and wherein the upper frame is coupled to the insulating connection member.
20. The laundry treating apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the dryer further includes a lower frame coupled to the first side panel below the first front panel, wherein the control panel is coupled to the lower frame, and wherein a signal connection line (i) extends from an interior of the dryer, (ii) passes through a connection hole of the lower frame, and (iii) includes a connection jack that is connected to the control panel.
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